“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 3

The Reasons for Śrī Caitanya's Advent

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This chapter considers the reasons why Śrī Caitanya descended. At the end of His pastimes Śrī Kṛṣṇa reflected: how could the four *rasas* of those pastimes — *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra* (servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love) — once manifest in the world, become something people could relish? Reflecting thus, He Himself descended in the form of a devotee to show the world how to relish these *rasas* of *prema-bhakti*. The chief *dharma* of the age of Kali is *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and the *yuga-avatāra*, the avatāra of the age, can reveal it. But *prema-bhakti* in those four *rasas* no *aṁśa-avatāra* or any other avatāra has the power to give — only Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. Therefore Kṛṣṇacandra Himself took birth in Navadvīpa. The author cites the words of the *Bhāgavatam* and other scriptures as proof that Kṛṣṇa Himself would take birth. By the marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great personality, he establishes that Caitanya is Bhagavān Himself. He further shows that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended with His limbs and their parts (*aṅga-upāṅga*) — that is, with Advaita, Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa and the other devotees — and preached *hari-bhakti* to the world. For the world the avatāra of Caitanya is more precious than all other avatāras, and therefore He is hidden. He is perceived through devotion alone (He is *bhakti-vyaṅgya*): only a devotee is fit to see Him with the eye of devotion. He takes great pains to keep this precious truth secret, yet before the highest devotees He stands revealed. To keep Him hidden, the Vedas, Purāṇas and other scriptures mention His future appearance only by hints. This makes clear how hidden His concealed avatāra (*channa-avatāra*) is and how especially precious. Advaita Ācārya appeared together with his elders and saw that the world had become

utterly devoid of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He reasoned: “If some *aṁśa-avatāra* descends, He will not be able to bring the world good fortune. The world will be blessed only if I can make Kṛṣṇa Himself descend.” With this in mind he began to offer water and *tulasī* at Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet and to call out loudly (*huṅkāra*), so that Kṛṣṇa, the Truth free of all designations, would descend. At the prayer of a pure and guileless devotee, Kṛṣṇa manifests His supreme form, the form on which that devotee meditates. Therefore Gaurāṅga descended in answer to the loving call of the pure devotee Advaita Ācārya — to give *prema* to the world.

*Obeisance to Mahāprabhu in order to gather the conclusions (*siddhānta*) of devotion —*

श्रीचैतन्यप्रभुं वन्दे यत्पादाश्रयवीर्य्यतः ।
संगृह्णात्याकरव्रातादज्ञः सिद्धान्तसन्मणीन् ॥ १ ॥

śrī-caitanya-prabhuṁ vande
Śrī Caitanya the Lord I worship
yat-pādāśraya-vīryataḥ
by the power of taking shelter at whose feet
saṅgṛhṇāty ākara-vrātād
gathers from the mines the multitude
ajñaḥ siddhānta-san-maṇīn
an ignorant man of conclusive truth the precious jewels

1 I worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. By the power of taking shelter at His feet, even an ignorant person gathers the precious jewels of conclusive truth from a multitude of mines.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Śrī Caitanya Prabhu. By the strength of shelter at His feet even an ignorant person can gather from the mines of the scriptures the finest jewels of *siddhānta*, the conclusions of truth.

Anubhāṣya.

A verse composed by the author himself.

ajñaḥ (even an ignorant person) **yat-pādāśraya-vīryataḥ** (by the power of shelter at whose feet, that is, at the feet of Śrī Caitanya) **ākara-vrātāt** (from the many mines, the places where metals are born) **siddhānta-san-maṇīn** (the true jewels of

conclusions) **saṅgṛhṇāti** (is able to gather fully) ([that]) **śrī-caitanya-prabhum** (Śrī Caitanya Prabhu) ([I]) **vande** (worship).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaita-candra glory to Gaura's devotees host

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

তৃতীয় শ্লোকের অর্থ কৈল বিবরণ ।
চতুর্থ শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন ভক্তগণ ॥ ৩ ॥

tṛtīya ślokera artha kaila vivaraṇa
of the third verse of the meaning I have made the explanation
caturtha ślokera artha śuna bhakta-gaṇa
of the fourth verse the meaning hear O devotees

3 I have explained the meaning of the third verse. Now, O devotees, hear the meaning of the fourth.

*Explanation of the fourth of the fourteen opening verses (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 2) —*

অনর্পিতচরীং চিরাৎ করুণয়াবতীর্ণঃ কলৌ
সমর্পয়িতুমুন্নতোজ্জ্বলরসাং স্বভক্তিশ্রিয়ম্ ।
হরিঃ পুরটসুন্দরদ্যুতিকদম্বসন্দীপিতঃ
সদা হৃদয়কন্দরে স্ফুরতু বঃ শচীনন্দনঃ ॥ ৪ ॥

anarpita-carīṁ cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau
not given before for a long time out of mercy descended in the age of Kali
samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasāṁ sva-bhakti-śriyam
to bestow most exalted radiant rasa the treasure of devotion to Himself
hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ
Hari than gold more beautiful of radiance by a mass illumined
sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanaḥ
always in the cave of the heart may He shine your the son of Śacī

4 "Out of mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a long time: the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted and radiant *rasa* of divine love. May that Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, resplendent with a mass of radiance more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the cave of your heart." (Vidagdha-mādhava 1.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May Hari, the son of Śacī, radiant with masses of golden splendor, manifest within your hearts. He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow the treasure of devotion to Himself — the supreme *ujjvala-rasa*, the radiant *rasa* of amorous love, which He had never before given to the world.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī used this verse as the *maṅgalācaraṇa* (blessing the world) at the opening of his play *Vidagdha-mādhava*. The author, his follower, therefore follows in the footsteps of his own beloved guru.

cirāt (for a long time) **anarpita-carīm** (never given before) **unnatojjvala-rasām** (in which the *ujjvala-rasa*, the *rasa* of amorous love [*śṛṅgāra*], is exalted, that is, fully developed) **sva-bhakti-śriyam** (the beauty of love for Himself) **samarpayitum** (in order to bestow fully) **kalau** (in the age of Kali) **karuṇayā avatīrṇaḥ** (who has come into the world out of mercy) **puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ** (He who is brightly illumined by a mass of beautiful golden radiance) **śacī-nandanaḥ** (the son of Śacī) **hariḥ** (Hari) **vaḥ** (your) **hṛdaya-kandare** (in the cave of the heart, that is, of the mind) **sadā** (always, day and night) **sphuratu** (may He manifest).

The time of His descent —

পূর্ণ ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ।
গোলোকে ব্রজের সহ নিত্য বিহার ॥ ৫ ॥

pūrṇa bhagavān kṛṣṇa vrajendra-kumāra
complete Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa the son of the king of Vraja
goloke vrajera saha nitya vihāra
in Goloka Vraja together with eternal pastimes

5 Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is the Supreme Lord in His fullness. Together with His Vraja He enjoys eternal pastimes in Goloka.

ব্রহ্মার একদিনে তিঁহো একবার ।
অবতীর্ণ হঞা করেন প্রকট বিহার ॥ ৬ ॥

brahmāra eka dine tiṅho eka-bāra
of Brahmā in one day He once
avatīrṇa hañā karena prakaṭa vihāra
having descended performs manifest pastimes

6 Once in a day of Brahmā He descends and displays these pastimes openly in this world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The previous chapter established that Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān in full. He eternally enjoys His pastimes in Goloka, the majestic manifestation (*vaibhava*) of Gokula, with everything that makes up the *rasa* of Vraja. These are called His unmanifest pastimes (*aprakaṭa-vihāra*). Descending into the world, He displays His manifest pastimes (*prakaṭa-vihāra*) once in every *kalpa*, that is, once in every day of Brahmā.

সত্য, ত্রেতা, দ্বাপর, কলি, চারিযুগ জানি ।
সেই চারিযুগে দিব্য একযুগ মানি ॥ ৭ ॥

satya, tretā, dvāpara, kali, cāri-yuga jāni
Satya Tretā Dvāpara Kali four ages we know
sei cāri-yuge divya eka-yuga māni
those four ages divine one age we count

7 There are four ages: Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali. Together these four are counted as one divine age (*divya-yuga*).

একাত্তর চতুর্যুগে এক মন্বন্তর ।
চৌদ্দ মন্বন্তর ব্রহ্মার দিবস ভিতর ॥ ৮ ॥

ekāttara catur-yuge eka manv-antara
in seventy-one cycles of four ages one manvantara
caudda manv-antara brahmāra divasa bhitara
fourteen manvantaras of Brahmā of the day within

8 Seventy-one such cycles make one *manvantara*, the reign of a Manu, and a day of Brahmā holds fourteen manvantaras.

Anubhāṣya.

The age of Kali lasts 432,000 solar years. Dvāpara has twice as many years as Kali, Tretā three times as many and Satya four times as many. Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali together therefore last 4,320,000 solar years. This *mahā-yuga* has been given the name *divya-yuga*. Seventy-one such *mahā-yugas* make one *manvantara*. Fourteen *manvantaras*, together with the junctions (*sandhi*) between them, which altogether equal fifteen Satya-yugas, make a thousand *yugas* — one day of Brahmā, or a *kalpa*.

"…A *catur-yuga* is declared to be, in solar years, [the numbers] two, three and [the four] oceans, multiplied by ten thousand.[0] Seventy-one such *yugas* are here called a *manvantara*. Know that in a *kalpa* there are fourteen Manus together with their junctions [*sandhi*]; at the beginning of the *kalpa* there is one more junction, as long as a Kṛta-yuga, and so fifteen are counted. Thus a *kalpa* of a thousand *yugas*, which brings about the destruction of living beings, is called a day of Brahmā; his night is just as long." (*Sūrya-siddhānta*, the chapter on mean motions [*Madhyamādhikāra*])

‘বৈবস্বত’ নাম এই সপ্তম মন্বন্তর ।
সাতাইশ চতুর্যুগ গেলে তাহার অন্তর ॥ ৯ ॥

‘vaivasvata’ nāma ei saptama manv-antara
Vaivasvata by name this seventh manvantara
sātāiśa catur-yuga gele tāhāra antara
twenty-seven cycles of four ages having passed of it within

9 The present manvantara, the seventh, is called Vaivasvata. When twenty-seven of its cycles of four ages have passed,

Anubhāṣya.
Mahāprabhu appears in the *manvantara* of the seventh Manu, named Vaivasvata. “The first Manu was Svāyambhuva. [After him] were born Svārociṣa, Uttama, Tāmasa, then Raivata and Cākṣuṣa; the present one, the seventh, is Vaivasvata. After him come Sāvarṇi, Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, Brahma-sāvarṇi, Dharma-sāvarṇi, Rudraputra, Raucya and Bhautyaka.” These are the fourteen Manus: (1) Svāyambhuva, (2) Svārociṣa, (3) Uttama, (4) Tāmasa, (5) Raivata, (6) Cākṣuṣa, (7) Vaivasvata, (8) Sāvarṇi, (9) Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, (10) Brahma-sāvarṇi, (11) Dharma-sāvarṇi, (12) Rudraputra (Sāvarṇi), (13) Raucya (Deva-sāvarṇi), (14) Bhautyaka (Indra-sāvarṇi). The reign of each lasts 71 *mahā-yugas*.

অষ্টাবিংশ চতুর্যুগে দ্বাপরের শেষে ।
ব্রজের সহিতে হয় কৃষ্ণের প্রকাশে ॥ ১০ ॥

aṣṭāviṁśa catur-yuge dvāparera śeṣe
in the twenty-eighth cycle of four ages of Dvāpara at the end
vrajera sahite haya kṛṣṇera prakāśe
Vraja together with takes place of Kṛṣṇa the manifestation

10 at the end of the Dvāpara age of the twenty-eighth cycle, Kṛṣṇa appears in this world together with His Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* in the *manvantara* of Vaivasvata, Kṛṣṇa appears with everything that belongs to the truth of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Of the 71 *mahā-yugas* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*, 27 have passed. In the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga*, after Satya and Tretā have passed, the time of Kṛṣṇa's manifest presence comes at the end of Dvāpara. From the beginning of Brahmā's day to the end of that Dvāpara, six Manus pass, together with their junctions. Adding this time to the 27 *yugas* of Vaivasvata Manu and to the Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara [of the twenty-eighth] (and subtracting the time of creation), one finds that $975{,}320{,}000^0$ solar years have passed.

*The four principal *rasas*, apart from *śānta* —*

দাস্য, সখ্য, বাৎসল্য, শৃঙ্গার — চারি রস ।
চারি ভাবের ভক্ত যত কৃষ্ণ তার বশ ॥ ১১ ॥

dāsya, sakhya, vātsalya, śṛṅgāra — cāri rasa
servitude friendship parental love amorous love four rasas
cāri bhāvera bhakta yata kṛṣṇa tāra vaśa
of the four moods devotees all Kṛṣṇa their under the sway

11 Servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love are the four *rasas*. Kṛṣṇa is under the sway of all the devotees who love Him in these four moods.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rasa is the very substance of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes. *Rasa* is of five kinds: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*. Of these, Kṛṣṇa is wholly subject to the devotees of four — *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*.

Anubhāṣya.
Śānta-rasa is not named here for this reason. In the material world *śānta-rasa* stands highest of all, but in the spiritual world it stands very low. *Śānta-rasa* is transcendental, yet in it the *ālambana* of *rasa* — the *viṣaya* and the *āśrayas*, the object of love and those who love — do not exchange the roles of knower and known. Therefore in *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa* love for Kṛṣṇa rises step by step in excellence.

দাস-সখা-পিতামাতা-প্রেয়সীগণ লঞা ।
ব্রজে ক্রীড়া করে কৃষ্ণ প্রেমাবিষ্ট হঞা ॥ ১২ ॥

dāsa-sakhā-pitā-mātā-preyasī-gaṇa lañā
servants friends father mother beloveds the host taking along
vraje krīḍā kare kṛṣṇa premāviṣṭa hañā
in Vraja play makes Kṛṣṇa absorbed in love becoming

12 With His servants, His friends, His father and mother and His beloveds, Kṛṣṇa sports in Vraja, absorbed in love.

An intimation of the Gaura-avatāra, in which magnanimity is foremost —

যথেষ্ট বিহরি' কৃষ্ণ করে অন্তর্ধান ।
অন্তর্ধান করি' মনে করে অনুমান ॥ ১৩ ॥

yatheṣṭa vihari' kṛṣṇa kare antardhāna
as He wished having sported Kṛṣṇa makes disappearance
antardhāna kari' mane kare anumāna
having disappeared in the mind makes reflection

13 When He has sported to His heart's content, Kṛṣṇa disappears. Then He reflects within Himself:

চিরকাল নাহি করি প্রেমভক্তি দান ।
ভক্তি বিনা জগতের নাহি অবস্থান ॥ ১৪ ॥

cira-kāla nāhi kari prema-bhakti dāna
for a long time not I have made of loving devotion the gift
bhakti vinā jagatera nāhi avasthāna
devotion without of the world no standing

14 "For a long time I have not given the gift of loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*). Without devotion the world cannot truly stand.

*The world is driven by *vaidhī-bhakti* and therefore knows nothing of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

সকল জগতে মোরে করে বিধি-ভক্তি ।
বিধিভক্ত্যে ব্রজভাব পাইতে নাহি শক্তি ॥ ১৫ ॥

sakala jagate more kare vidhi-bhakti
in the whole world Me they make devotion by rules
vidhi-bhaktye vraja-bhāva pāite nāhi śakti
by devotion by rules the mood of Vraja to attain not the power

15 Everywhere in the world people worship Me by the rules of scripture (*vidhi-bhakti*). But devotion by rules has no power to attain the mood of Vraja.

*In the mood of reverence, love for Kṛṣṇa, which is attained by pure *rāga* (spontaneous attraction), is extremely rare —*

ঐশ্বর্য্যজ্ঞানেতে সব জগৎ মিশ্রিত ।
ঐশ্বর্য্য-শিথিল-প্রেমে নাহি মোর প্রীত ॥ ১৬ ॥

aiśvarya-jñānete saba jagat miśrita
of majesty with awareness the whole world is mixed
aiśvarya-śithila-preme nāhi mora prīta
by majesty weakened in love not My pleasure

16 The whole world is tinged with awareness of My majesty, and love weakened by awe of My majesty does not please Me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Until now I have not given *prema-bhakti* to the world. People in the world read the scriptures and worship Me through *vidhi-bhakti*, devotion by rules. But My highest mood is the mood of Vraja, and *vidhi-bhakti* cannot attain it. In *vidhi-bhakti* the awareness of My majesty (*aiśvarya-jñāna*) prevails. In the mood of majesty *prema* grows slack — that is, it loses its depth. Therefore such *prema* does not please Me."

*The fruit of *vaidhī-bhakti* full of reverence: the four kinds of liberation and attaining Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha —*

ঐশ্বর্য্যজ্ঞানে বিধি ভজন করিয়া ।
বৈকুণ্ঠকে যায় চতুর্ব্বিধ মুক্তি পাঞা ॥ ১৭ ॥

aiśvarya-jñāne vidhi bhajana kariyā
in awareness of majesty by rules worship doing
vaikuṇṭhake yāya catur-vidha mukti pāñā
to Vaikuṇṭha they go four kinds of liberation attaining

17 Those who worship by the rules, aware of My majesty, attain the four kinds of liberation and go to Vaikuṇṭha:

সার্ষ্টি, সারূপ্য, আর সামীপ্য, সালোক্য ।
সাযুজ্য না লয় ভক্ত যাতে ব্রহ্ম-ঐক্য ॥ ১৮ ॥

sārṣṭi, sārūpya, āra sāmīpya, sālokya
equal opulence the same form and nearness the same world
sāyujya nā laya bhakta yāte brahma-aikya
merging not accepts the devotee in which oneness with Brahman

18 *sārṣṭi*, opulence equal to Mine; *sārūpya*, a form like Mine; *sāmīpya*, nearness to Me; and *sālokya*, residence in My world. The devotee never accepts *sāyujya*, merging, in which one becomes one with Brahman.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Sārṣṭi is attaining majesty equal to Viṣṇu's; *sārūpya* is attaining a form like Viṣṇu's, with four arms and the other limbs and the same complexion; *sāmīpya* is dwelling near Viṣṇu; *sālokya* is living in Viṣṇu's world.

Anubhāṣya.

“Even when I offer them *sālokya*, *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and even oneness [with Me], people do not accept anything other than serving Me.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.29.13); see also (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.7.67).[0]

Kṛṣṇa's own desire to teach how to worship Him —

যুগধর্ম্ম প্রবর্ত্তামু নাম-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
চারি ভাব-ভক্তি দিয়া নাচামু ভুবন ॥ ১৯ ॥

yuga-dharma pravartāmu nāma-saṅkīrtana
the religion of the age I shall establish of the Name congregational chanting
cāri bhāva-bhakti diyā nācāmu bhuvana
of the four moods devotion giving I shall make dance the world

19 I shall establish the religion of the age, the congregational chanting of the Holy Name (*nāma-saṅkīrtana*). Giving devotion in the four moods, I shall make the whole world dance.

For this very reason He descends as a devotee and a guru; preaching and personal example —

আপনি করিমু ভক্তভাব অঙ্গীকারে ।
আপনি আচরি' ভক্তি শিখামু সবারে ॥ ২০ ॥

āpani karimu bhakta-bhāva aṅgīkāre
Myself I shall make of a devotee the mood acceptance
āpani ācari' bhakti śikhāmu sabāre
Myself practising devotion I shall teach to everyone

20 I Myself shall take the mood of a devotee, and by practising devotion Myself I shall teach it to everyone.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Those who worship Me on the path of rules, aware of My majesty, attain the four kinds of liberation — *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sālokya* — and go to Vaikuṇṭha. For *sāyujya-mukti*, liberation as oneness with Brahman, even the followers of *vidhi-bhakti* do not pray. But once devotees attain *prema-bhakti*, they reject even those four kinds of liberation and live in the happiness of serving Me. It is My desire to preach to the world this *prema-bhakti*, which lies beyond *vidhi-bhakti*. I will give the world the *dharma* of the age of Kali, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, together with the *rasas* of *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*, and make all people dance. And I Myself will accept the mood of a devotee and teach the living beings of the world by My own conduct."

Preaching without personal example is fruitless —

আপনে না কৈলে ধর্ম্ম শিখান না যায়।
এই ত' সিদ্ধান্ত গীতা-ভাগবতে গায় ॥ ২১ ॥

āpane nā kaile dharma śikhāna nā yāya
oneself not having done religion to teach not is possible
ei ta' siddhānta gītā-bhāgavate gāya
this indeed conclusion in the Gītā and the Bhāgavatam they sing

21 Unless one practises religion oneself, one cannot teach it. This conclusion is sung in the Gītā and the Bhāgavatam:

*The time of descent (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 4, verses 7–8) —*

যদা যদা হি ধর্ম্মস্য গ্লানির্ভবতি ভারত।
অভ্যুত্থানমধর্ম্মস্য তদাত্মানং সৃজাম্যহম্ ॥ ২২ ॥

yadā yadā hi dharmasya
whenever whenever indeed of religion
glānir bhavati bhārata
a decline occurs O descendant of Bharata
abhyutthānam adharmasya
the rise of irreligion
tadātmānaṁ sṛjāmy aham
then Myself manifest I

22 "Whenever religion declines and irreligion rises, O descendant of Bharata, I manifest Myself." (Bhagavad-gītā 4.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Arjuna, whenever *dharma* declines and *adharma* rises, I manifest Myself.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa recalled ancient times. The path of yoga He had once told the sun-god had been lost over time, so He told it again to Arjuna. To convince Arjuna, Bhagavān speaks of His own appearance:

he bhārata yadā yadā hi dharmasya glāniḥ (decline) **adharmasya abhyutthānam** (increase) **bhavati**, **tadā aham** (unable to bear these two

[calamities], and in order to reverse them) **ātmānaṁ sṛjāmi**.

The work of the avatāra —

পরিত্রাণায় সাধূনাং বিনাশায় চ দুষ্কৃতাম্ ৷
ধর্ম্মসংস্থাপনার্থায় সম্ভবামি যুগে যুগে ॥ ২৩ ॥

paritrāṇāya sādhūnāṁ
for the deliverance of the saintly
vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām
for the destruction and of the wicked
dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya
of religion for the sake of establishing
sambhavāmi yuge yuge
I appear in age after age

23 "To deliver the saintly, to destroy the wicked and to establish religion, I appear age after age." (Bhagavad-gītā 4.8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To deliver the sādhus, to destroy the wicked and to establish *dharma*, I appear in every *yuga*.

Anubhāṣya.
sādhūnām (of those wholly devoted to serving Me) **paritrāṇāya** (to remove the obstacles to their service) **duṣkṛtām** (of the enemies of the devotees — Rāvaṇa, Kaṁsa, Keśī and others, whom no one but I can slay) **vināśāya**, **dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya ca** (and in order to practise and preach properly the *dharma* free of envy — devotion to the service of Bhagavān, which consists of *paricaryā* [service] and *saṅkīrtana*) **yuge yuge** (at the respective times) **sambhavāmi**.

*Preaching without personal example is futile and bears poisonous fruit (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 3, verse 24) —*

উৎসীদেয়ুরিমে লোকা ন কুর্য্যাং কর্ম্ম চেদহম্ ৷
সঙ্করস্য চ কর্ত্তা স্যামুপহন্যামিমাঃ প্রজাঃ ॥ ২৪ ॥

utsīdeyur ime lokā
would perish these worlds
na kuryāṁ karma ced aham
not would perform action if I
saṅkarasya ca kartā syām
of confusion of the social orders and the cause I would be
upahanyām imāḥ prajāḥ
I would ruin these people

24 "If I did not perform action, these worlds would perish. I would cause confusion among the social orders and ruin all these people." (Bhagavad-gītā 3.24)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
If I do not uphold the order of duties (*karma*) by performing My duties, this world will be ruined. I will become the cause of the mixing of the social orders, and I Myself will turn out to be the destroyer of the people.

Anubhāṣya.
Arjuna asked a doubting question about action. In reply, Bhagavān, who has no desire for material enjoyment, explains why He acts (sets an example):

cet (if) **ahaṁ karma na kuryām**, **ime lokāḥ utsīdeyuḥ** (would fall, taking Me as their example), **saṅkarasya ca kartā syām**, **imāḥ prajāḥ upahanyām** (I would make impure).

*The conduct of one who sets the example is the model for ordinary people (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 3, verse 21) —*

যদ্যদাচরতি শ্রেষ্ঠস্তত্তদেবেতরো জনঃ ।
স যৎ প্রমাণং কুরুতে লোকস্তদনুবর্ত্ততে ॥ ২৫ ॥

yad yad ācarati śreṣṭhas
whatever whatever does a great man
tat tad evetaro janaḥ
that that indeed other people
sa yat pramāṇaṁ kurute
he whatever the standard makes
lokas tad anuvartate
the world that follows

25 "Whatever a great man does, others do the same. Whatever standard he sets, the world follows." (Bhagavad-gītā 3.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Whatever the best person does, others imitate. Whatever the best declares to be the "standard," everyone follows and holds dear.

Anubhāṣya.
śreṣṭhaḥ (a *mahājana*, a great soul) **yad yad yathā ācarati**, **tat tad** (the same) **itaraḥ** (the lesser) **janaḥ** ([does]); **saḥ** (the best) **yat pramāṇaṁ kurute**, **lokaḥ** (the other person) **tad anuvartate** (follows it).

*Preaching the *dharma* of the age is Viṣṇu's work, but no *aṁśa* of the Viṣṇu-*tattva* other than Kṛṣṇa can give love for Kṛṣṇa —*

যুগধর্ম্ম-প্রবর্ত্তন হয় অংশ হৈতে ।
আমা বিনা অন্যে নারে ব্রজপ্রেম দিতে ॥ ২৬ ॥

yuga-dharma-pravartana haya aṁśa haite
of the religion of the age the establishment takes place a portion from
āmā vinā anye nāre vraja-prema dite
Me except others cannot the love of Vraja to give

26 The religion of each age is established by My partial manifestations, but no one except Me can give the love of Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I wish to appear in order to preach two things: the *dharma* of the age, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and the love of Vraja. An *aṁśa-avatāra* can do the work of

preaching the *dharma* of the age. But no one other than Me — Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān in full — can preach the love of Vraja."

*The words of Bilvamaṅgala in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (first part, 5.37) —*

সন্ত্ববতারা বহবঃ পঙ্কজনাভস্য সর্ব্বতো-ভদ্রাঃ ।
কৃষ্ণাদন্যঃ কো বা লতাস্বপি প্রেমদো ভবতি ॥ ২৭ ॥

santv avatārā bahavaḥ
let there be avatāras many
paṅkaja-nābhasya sarvato-bhadrāḥ
of the lotus-naveled Lord all-auspicious
kṛṣṇād anyaḥ ko vā latāsv
than Kṛṣṇa other who indeed to the creepers
api prema-do bhavati
even love the giver is

27 "Let the lotus-naveled Lord have many avatāras, all of them auspicious in every way. But who other than Kṛṣṇa gives love even to the creepers?" (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta 1.5.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān Paṅkajanābha may have many auspicious avatāras. But who other than Kṛṣṇa gives *prema* to the creepers — that is, to those who have taken shelter of Him?

Anubhāṣya.
paṅkaja-nābhasya (of Bhagavān Padmanābha) **sarvato-bhadrāḥ** (bestowing auspiciousness) **bahavaḥ avatārāḥ santu**; **api kṛṣṇāt anyaḥ ko vā latāsu** (to those who have taken shelter of Him) **prema-daḥ** (the giver of *prema-bhakti*) **bhavati**.

তাহাতে আপন ভক্তগণ করি' সঙ্গে ।
পৃথিবীতে অবতরি' করিমু নানা রঙ্গে ॥ ২৮ ॥

tāhāte āpana bhakta-gaṇa kari' saṅge
therefore My own devotees making companions
pṛthivīte avatari' karimu nānā raṅge
on earth descending I shall do various pastimes

28 Therefore I shall descend to earth with My own devotees as My companions and enjoy many kinds of pastimes."

এত ভাবি' কলিকালে প্রথম সন্ধ্যায় ।
অবতীর্ণ হৈলা কৃষ্ণ আপনি নদীয়ায় ॥ ২৯ ॥

eta bhāvi' kali-kāle prathama sandhyāya
thus thinking in the age of Kali in the first junction
avatīrṇa hailā kṛṣṇa āpani nadīyāya
descended became Kṛṣṇa Himself in Nadia

29 Thinking in this way, Kṛṣṇa Himself descended in Nadia in the first period (*sandhyā*) of the age of Kali.

Anubhāṣya.
Prathama sandhyā: the first *sandhyā*. A *sandhyā* is the time at the beginning and at the end of a *yuga*, which [together] make up a sixth part of the *yuga*. The first *sandhyā* of a *yuga* is a twelfth part, and the last *sandhyā* is also a twelfth. The first *sandhyā* of the age of Kali is therefore 36,000 solar years. Śrī Gaurasundara appeared when 4,586 years of the age of Kali had passed; therefore He took birth in the first *sandhyā*, in Śrī Māyāpura Navadvīpa. "The *sandhyās* of Kṛta and the other *yugas* are, in order, a sixth part of their own *yuga*." (Śrī *Sūrya-siddhānta*, *Madhyamādhikāra*, verse 17)

চৈতন্যসিংহের নবদ্বীপে অবতার ।
সিংহগ্রীব, সিংহবীর্য্য, সিংহের হুঙ্কার ॥ ৩০ ॥

caitanya-siṁhera navadvīpe avatāra
of the lion Caitanya in Navadvīpa the descent
siṁha-grīva, siṁha-vīrya, siṁhera huṅkāra
a lion's neck a lion's strength of a lion the roar

30 Thus the lion Caitanya descended in Navadvīpa. He had the neck of a lion, the strength of a lion and the roar of a lion.

সেই সিংহ বসুক্ জীবের হৃদয়-কন্দরে ।
কল্মষ-দ্বিরদ নাশে যাঁহার হুঙ্কারে ॥ ৩১ ॥

sei siṁha vasuk jīvera hṛdaya-kandare
that lion may He sit of the soul of the heart in the cave
kalmaṣa-dvirada nāśe yāṅhāra huṅkāre
of sin the elephant is destroyed whose by the roar

31 May that lion take His seat in the cave of the heart of every soul. His roar destroys the elephant of sin.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kalmaṣa means sin; *dvirada*, an elephant.

*The name "Viśvambhara" — the presiding deity of *abhidheya*, the means —*

প্রথম লীলায় তাঁর 'বিশ্বম্ভর' নাম ।
ভক্তিরসে ভরিল, ধরিল ভূতগ্রাম ॥ ৩২ ॥

prathama līlāya tāṅra 'viśvambhara' nāma
in the first pastimes His Viśvambhara the name
bhakti-rase bharila, dharila bhūta-grāma
with the rasa of devotion He filled He sustained the host of beings

32 In His early pastimes His name was Viśvambhara, for He filled the world with the *rasa* of devotion and sustained all living beings.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhūta-grāma is the multitude of living beings.

ডুভৃঞ্ ধাতুর অর্থ — পোষণ, ধারণ ।
পুষিল, ধরিল প্রেম দিয়া ত্রিভুবন ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ḍu-bhṛñ-dhātura artha — poṣaṇa, dhāraṇa
ḍubhṛñ of the verbal root the meaning nourishing sustaining
puṣila, dharila prema diyā tri-bhuvana
He nourished He sustained love giving the three worlds

33 The verbal root *ḍubhṛñ* means “to nourish” and “to sustain.” By giving love He nourished and sustained the three worlds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The word *Viśvambhara* is formed from the root *ḍubhṛñ*. The meaning of that root is to nourish and to sustain. By giving *prema* He nourished and sustained the three worlds.

*The name “Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya” — the presiding deity of *sambandha*, the relationship with the Lord —*

শেষলীলায় নাম ধরে ‘শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য’ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণ জানায়ে সব বিশ্ব কৈল ধন্য ॥ ৩৪ ॥

śeṣa-līlāya nāma dhare ‘śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya’
in the later pastimes the name He bears Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
śrī-kṛṣṇa jānāye saba viśva kaila dhanya
Śrī Kṛṣṇa making known the whole universe He made blessed

34 In His later pastimes He bears the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. By making Śrī Kṛṣṇa known, He blessed the whole universe.

Anubhāṣya.
“In His last pastimes”: that is, in the twenty-four years after He accepted *sannyāsa*. In the *sampradāya* of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī, *tridaṇḍī* Vedic *sannyāsīs* of the ten names and of the hundred and eight names existed long before Śrī Śaṅkarapāda. But when Śaṅkara arose — a Vedāntist in name only, fond of reasoning about the attributeless — the society of the *pañcopāsakas*, the worshippers of five deities, was reorganized in India on the principle of reconciling all doctrines. Therefore Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted Vedic *sannyāsa* according to the custom of the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names in the *sampradāya* of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya. In Āryāvarta, in an Ārya society that only resembles the Vedic — that is, merely calls itself a follower of the Vedas — many follow Śaṅkarācārya and, by the rule of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya*, worship the five deities.

The *sannyāsīs* of the ten names are these: “Tīrtha, Āśrama, Vana, Araṇya, Giri, Parvata, Sāgara, Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī — these are the ten names.” Below, for each, the title of the *sannyāsī*, the place and the title of the *brahmacārī* are given in order (see *Mañjuṣā*, issue 2, pp. 104–107). Tīrtha and Āśrama are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Dvārakā; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Svarūpa. Vana and Araṇya are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Puruṣottama; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Prakāśa. Giri, Parvata and Sāgara are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Badarikāśrama; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Ānanda. Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Śṛṅgerī; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Caitanya.

Śrī Śaṅkarācārya established four *maṭhas* — in the east, west, north and south of India — and put four of his disciples at their head. Under these four principal *maṭhas* countless branch *maṭhas* gradually arose. The *maṭhas* are assigned to regions, but in many cases this order has been upset. In the four *maṭhas* there are four *sampradāyas*: Ānandavāra, Bhogavāra, Kīṭavāra and Bhūmivāra. Over time the understanding of these *sampradāyas*, too, has become confused. The four *mahāvākyas*, the great sayings, are also divided among the *maṭhas*. To accept *sannyāsa*, one must first go to a *sannyāsī* guru who heads a *maṭha* and become a *brahmacārī*. Whatever kind of *sannyāsī* that guru is, he gives the corresponding *brahmacārī* name. This custom is still strictly kept in this *sampradāya* today.

When Śrī Mahāprabhu went to Keśava Bhāratī to accept *sannyāsa*, His name became “Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.” Even after accepting *sannyāsa*, Bhagavān made known only His *brahmacārī* name. None of those who wrote of His pastimes says that He introduced Himself by the title “Bhāratī.” In Śaṅkara's *sampradāya* the *sannyāsa* name is bound up with the conceit of being God (*īśvarābhimāna*); this, I think, is why Śrīman Mahāprabhu did not favor that usage. The *brahmacārī* name carries the self-conception of a servant of the guru (*guru-dāsyābhimāna*) and is not unfavorable to devotion. It is recorded, however, that Mahāprabhu accepted the *daṇḍa*, the *kamaṇḍalu* and the other marks of *sannyāsa*.

তাঁর যুগাবতার জানি’ গর্গ মহাশয়।
কৃষ্ণের নামকরণে করিয়াছে নির্ণয় ॥ ৩৫ ॥

tāṅra yugāvatāra jāni' garga mahāśaya
His as the avatāra for the age knowing Garga the great soul
kṛṣṇera nāma-karaṇe kariyāche nirṇaya
of Kṛṣṇa at the name-giving ceremony has made a determination

35 Knowing Him to be the avatāra for the age, the great sage Garga declared it at Kṛṣṇa's name-giving ceremony:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Garga Mahāśaya knew that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the avatāra of the age of Kali, and in the following verse he specified His color.

*Avatāras of four colors in the four *yugas* (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 8, verse 13) —*

আসন্ বর্ণাস্ত্রয়ো হ্যস্য গৃহ্ণতোঽনুযুগং তনূঃ ।
শুক্লো রক্তস্তথা পীত ইদানীং কৃষ্ণতাং গতঃ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

āsan varṇās trayo hy asya
there were colors three indeed of Him
gṛhṇato 'nu-yugaṁ tanūḥ
who accepts in each age bodies
śuklo raktas tathā pīta
white red and also yellow
idānīṁ kṛṣṇatāṁ gataḥ
now darkness has attained

36 "Your son appears in every age, accepting a body. He has had three colors: white, red and yellow. Now He has come dark." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.8.13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"This boy of yours takes on white, red and yellow colors in the other three *yugas*; now, in Dvāpara, He has become black."

Anubhāṣya.
Garga Mahāśaya explains to Nanda Mahārāja why Kṛṣṇa is given this name, and in doing so he speaks of His other avatāras and of His being the source of avatāras:

anu-yugam (as befits each *yuga*) **tanūḥ gṛhṇataḥ asya** (of your son) **śuklaḥ raktaḥ tathā** (these words point to the future: in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *mahā-yuga* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*) **pītaḥ** (He will be yellow) **trayaḥ varṇāḥ āsan**. **idānīṁ hi kṛṣṇatāṁ gataḥ** (has attained).

শুক্ল, রক্ত, পীতবর্ণ — এই তিন দ্যুতি ।
সত্য-ত্রেতা-কলিকালে ধরেন শ্রীপতি ॥ ৩৭ ॥

śukla, rakta, pīta-varṇa — ei tina dyuti
white red yellow color these three lusters
satya-tretā-kali-kāle dharena śrī-pati
in the Satya, Tretā and Kali ages assumes the husband of Śrī

37 The husband of Śrī assumes these three lusters, white, red and yellow, in the Satya, Tretā and Kali ages.

ইদানীং দ্বাপরে তিঁহো হৈলা কৃষ্ণবর্ণ ।
এই সব শাস্ত্রাগমপুরাণের মর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৮ ॥

idānīṁ dvāpare tiṅho hailā kṛṣṇa-varṇa
now in Dvāpara He became dark in color
ei saba śāstrāgama-purāṇera marma
this all of the scriptures, Āgamas and Purāṇas the essence

38 Now, in the Dvāpara age, He has become dark. This is the essence of the scriptures, the Āgamas and the Purāṇas.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 11, Chapter 5, verse 27)*

দ্বাপরে ভগবান্ শ্যামঃ পীতবাসা নিজায়ুধঃ ।
শ্রীবৎসাদিভিরঙ্কৈশ্চ লক্ষণৈরুপলক্ষিতঃ ॥ ৩৯ ॥

dvāpare bhagavān śyāmaḥ
in Dvāpara the Lord dark
pīta-vāsā nijāyudhaḥ
in yellow garments with His own weapons
śrī-vatsādibhir aṅkaiś ca
with the Śrīvatsa and other marks and
lakṣaṇair upalakṣitaḥ
with signs distinguished

39 "In the Dvāpara age the Lord appears dark, clad in yellow, bearing His own weapons and marked with the Śrīvatsa and other signs." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the Dvāpara-yuga Bhagavān is marked in this way: He is dark in color, wears yellow garments, holds His own weapons — the flute and the rest — and bears the Śrīvatsa and other marks.

Anubhāṣya.
Nimi, the king of Videha, asked at what time and in what way the avatāras of Bhagavān descend. In reply, one of the nine Yogendras, Śrī Karabhājana, described the avatāras of Satya and Tretā and then speaks of the avatāra of Dvāpara:

dvāpare bhagavān śyāmaḥ pīta-vāsāḥ (He whose garments are yellow) **nijāyudhaḥ** (He who bears His own weapons — the club, the disc and the rest) **śrī-vatsādibhiḥ aṅkaiḥ** (by marks on His body) **lakṣaṇaiḥ** (and by external signs, such as the Kaustubha) **upalakṣitaḥ**.

The marks of the avatāra of the age of Kali —

কলিযুগে যুগধর্ম্ম — নামের প্রচার ।
তথি লাগি' পীতবর্ণ চৈতন্যাবতার ॥ ৪০ ॥

kali-yuge yuga-dharma — nāmera pracāra
in the age of Kali the religion of the age of the Name the spreading
tathi lāgi' pīta-varṇa caitanyāvatāra
for that purpose yellow in color the avatāra Caitanya

40 In the age of Kali the religion of the age is spreading the Holy Name. For this purpose the Lord has descended as Caitanya, yellow in color.

Anubhāṣya.

In his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*, Śrī Madhvācārya cites this evidence from the *Śrī Nārāyaṇa-saṁhitā*: “In Dvāpara people worship Viṣṇu by the *Pañcarātras* alone, but in Kali Bhagavān Hari is worshipped by the name alone.” The *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad* also says: “Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare — these sixteen names destroy the contamination of the age of Kali. No means higher than this is found in all the Vedas.”

তপ্তহেম-সম কান্তি, প্রকাণ্ড শরীর ।
নবমেঘ জিনি কণ্ঠধ্বনি যে গম্ভীর ॥ ৪১ ॥

tapta-hema-sama kānti, prakāṇḍa śarīra
of molten gold like the luster mighty body
nava-megha jini kaṇṭha-dhvani ye gambhīra
new clouds surpassing the sound of the voice that deep

41 His luster is like molten gold and His body is tall and mighty. His deep voice surpasses the thunder of fresh rain clouds.

দৈর্ঘ্য-বিস্তারে যেই আপনার হাত ।
চারি হস্ত হয় ‘মহাপুরুষ’ বিখ্যাত ॥ ৪২ ॥

dairghya-vistāre yei āpanāra hāta
in height and in breadth who his own cubits
cāri hasta haya ‘mahā-puruṣa’ vikhyāta
four cubits is a mahā-puruṣa is known as

42 One whose height and the span of whose arms both measure four of his own cubits is known as a *mahā-puruṣa*, a great personality.

‘ন্যগ্রোধপরিমণ্ডল’ হয় তাঁর নাম ।
ন্যগ্রোধপরিমণ্ডল-তনু চৈতন্য গুণধাম ॥ ৪৩ ॥

'nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala' haya tāṅra nāma
nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala is his name
nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala-tanu caitanya guṇa-dhāma
of nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala the body Caitanya of virtues the abode

43 Such a person is called *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*, "proportioned like a banyan tree." Caitanya, the abode of all virtues, has such a body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He whose height equals four of his own cubits, measured by the length and span of his arms, is famed as a *mahāpuruṣa*, and his name is *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*.

Anubhāṣya.
Nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala: one who is four of his own cubits tall and as many broad, that is, around, measured by his own arms, is a *mahāpuruṣa*. And He who has subdued (*nyak*) all living beings and holds them in check (*rodha*) by His own *māyā* is Viṣṇu in full, possessed of the *catur-vyūha*.

আজানুলম্বিত ভুজ কমললোচন ।
তিলফুল-জিনি-নাসা, সুধাংশু-বদন ॥ ৪৪ ॥

ājānulambita bhuja kamala-locana
to the knees reaching arms lotus eyes
tilaphula-jini-nāsā, sudhāṁśu-vadana
than the sesame flower surpassing nose the moon face

44 His arms reach down to His knees and His eyes are like lotuses. His nose is finer than the sesame flower, and His face is like the moon.

শান্ত, দান্ত, কৃষ্ণভক্তি-নিষ্ঠাপরায়ণ ।
ভক্তবৎসল, সুশীল, সর্ব্বভূতে সম ॥ ৪৫ ॥

śānta, dānta, kṛṣṇa-bhakti-niṣṭhā-parāyaṇa
peaceful self-controlled in devotion to Kṛṣṇa steadfastly wholly given
bhakta-vatsala, suśīla, sarva-bhūte sama
affectionate to devotees gentle to all beings equal

45 He is peaceful and self-controlled, wholly and steadfastly given to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He is affectionate to His devotees, gentle by nature and equal to all living beings.

চন্দনের অঙ্গদ-বালা, চন্দন-ভূষণ ।
নৃত্যকালে পরি' করেন কৃষ্ণসংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ৪৬ ॥

candanera aṅgada-bālā, candana-bhūṣaṇa
of sandalwood armlets bracelets sandal ornaments
nṛtya-kāle pari' karena kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
at the time of dancing wearing He performs Kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana

46 When He dances in the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's names, He wears armlets and bracelets of sandalwood and is adorned with sandal paste.

এই সব গুণ লঞা মুনি বৈশম্পায়ন ।
সহস্রনামে কৈল তাঁর নাম গণন ॥ ৪৭ ॥

ei saba guṇa lañā muni vaiśampāyana
these all qualities taking the sage Vaiśampāyana
sahasra-nāme kaila tāṅra nāma gaṇana
in the Thousand Names made His of names enumeration

47 Taking all these qualities into account, the sage Vaiśampāyana listed His names in the Thousand Names of Viṣṇu (*Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*).

Anubhāṣya.

Sahasra-nāma means the thousand names of Viṣṇu, that is, the *Mahābhārata*, the *Dāna-dharma* section, Chapter 149. Śaṅkarācārya and the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas down to Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa have written commentaries on this text.

দুই লীলা চৈতন্যের — আদি আর শেষ ।
দুই লীলায় চারি চারি নাম বিশেষ ॥ ৪৮ ॥

dui līlā caitanyera — ādi āra śeṣa
two pastimes of Caitanya the first and the last
dui līlāya cāri cāri nāma viśeṣa
in the two pastimes four four names special

48 Caitanya's pastimes have two parts, the early and the later, and in each He bears four special names.

Anubhāṣya.
Ādi, the first: the householder pastimes (the first 24 years); *śeṣa*, the last: the pastimes of *sannyāsa* (the last 24 years). See verses 32–34. “Four names each”: these are given in the next verse, 49.

*(*Mahābhārata*, *Dāna-dharma*, Chapter 149, *Sahasra-nāma*, 92 and 95)*

সুবর্ণবর্ণো হেমাঙ্গো বরাঙ্গশ্চন্দনাঙ্গদী ৷
সন্ন্যাসকৃচ্ছমঃ শান্তো নিষ্ঠাশান্তিপরায়ণঃ ॥ ৪৯ ॥

suvarṇa-varṇo hemāṅgo
of golden color with a body of gold
varāṅgaś candanāṅgadī
with beautiful limbs wearing sandalwood armlets
sannyāsa-kṛc chamaḥ śānto
accepting sannyāsa equipoised peaceful
niṣṭhā-śānti-parāyaṇaḥ
of steadfastness and peace the supreme abode

49 “His complexion is golden and His body is like gold. His limbs are beautiful, and He wears armlets of sandalwood. He accepts the renounced order (*sannyāsa*). He is equipoised and peaceful, the supreme abode of steadfastness and peace.” (Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma, Mahābhārata)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A golden color, a body like molten gold, a form beautiful in every limb, adornment with sandal and garlands — these four marks are seen in His pastimes as a householder. [In His pastimes of *sannyāsa* He is] a *sannyāsī*; He possesses the quality of *śama*, which consists in reflecting on the secrets of Hari; He is firmly fixed in the great sacrifice of *hari-kīrtana*; and He is wholly devoted to

mahābhāva, attained through *śānti* — the *śānti* that silences the non-devotees who hold to *kevalādvaita*, pure monism.

Anubhāṣya.

suvarṇa-varṇaḥ (He whose color is yellow, like the color of gold) **hemāṅgaḥ** (He whose body is like gold) **varāṅgaḥ** (He whose body bears the marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*) **candanāṅgadī** (He whose armlets are anointed with sandal) (these are four names of Bhagavān Gauracandra in His first pastimes). **sannyāsa-kṛt** (devoted to the duty of a renunciant) **śamaḥ** (free from sense objects) **śāntaḥ** (He whose mind is fixed on Kṛṣṇa alone) **niṣṭhā-śānti-parāyaṇaḥ** (*niṣṭhā* is one-pointedness of mind, and there is *śānti*; *niṣṭhā* and *śānti* are His highest shelter) (the *Sahasra-nāma* also cites these four names of Bhagavān Gaurahari in His last pastimes).

In Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa's commentary on the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*, called *Nāmārtha-sudhā*, it is said: "*Suvarṇa-varṇa*: 'His color, that is, His form, is like gold,' according to the Śruti: 'When the seer sees the golden Creator, the Lord, the Puruṣa, the source of Brahman.'[0] *Hemāṅga*: 'His limbs, the bearers of color, are as desirable as gold.' *Varāṅga*: 'His limbs are excellent, that is, full of beauty.' *Candanāṅgadī*: 'His armlets (*aṅgada*) are *candana*, that is, they gladden the hearts of the devotees.' Some apply these four names, beginning with *suvarṇa-varṇa*, to His form as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Now, with six names, the verse points to His being Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. *Sannyāsa-kṛt*: 'He who performs *sannyāsa*, the life of a wandering renunciant.' *Śama*: 'He who reflects (*śamayati*) on the secret of Hari'; the root *śam* in the sense of 'to reflect' belongs to the tenth class. *Śānta*: 'He who has withdrawn (*śāmyati*) from everything other than Kṛṣṇa.' *Niṣṭhā*: 'That in which the sacrifices of devotion abide (*nitiṣṭhanti*), the chief of which is *hari-kīrtana*' — for the *smṛti* says, *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* ("He who utters the name of Kṛṣṇa, yet is not dark").[0] *Śānti*: 'That by which the opponents of devotion, headed by the followers of *kevalādvaita*, are subdued.' *Parāyaṇa*: 'The highest shelter of all kinds of *bhāva*, up to *mahābhāva*.'"

ব্যক্ত করি' ভাগবতে কহে বার বার ।
কলিযুগে — কৃষ্ণনামসঙ্কীর্ত্তন সার ॥ ৫০ ॥

vyakta kari' bhāgavate kahe bāra bāra
clearly making in the Bhāgavatam it says again and again
kali-yuge — kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṅkīrtana sāra
in the age of Kali of Kṛṣṇa's name congregational chanting the essence

50 The Bhāgavatam says clearly, again and again, that in the age of Kali the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence of all religion.

*The *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name is the *dharma* of the age (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 11, Chapter 5, verse 32) —*

কৃষ্ণবর্ণং ত্বিষাঽকৃষ্ণং সাঙ্গোপাঙ্গাস্ত্রপার্ষদম্ ।
যজ্ঞৈঃ সঙ্কীর্ত্তনপ্রায়ৈর্যজন্তি হি সুমেধসঃ ॥ ৫১ ॥

kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣā 'kṛṣṇaṁ
uttering Kṛṣṇa by luster not dark
sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam
with limbs, sub-limbs, weapons and associates
yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyair
by sacrifices consisting chiefly of saṅkīrtana
yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ
worship indeed the intelligent

51 "Intelligent people worship, by sacrifices consisting chiefly of congregational chanting, the Lord who always utters the name 'Kṛṣṇa' (*kṛṣṇa-varṇam*) and whose luster is not dark. He is accompanied by His limbs, His sub-limbs, His weapons and His associates." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.5.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Intelligent people worship, with a sacrifice in which *saṅkīrtana* is foremost, the Great Personality (*Mahāpuruṣa*) in whose mouth the syllables "Kṛṣṇa" always dwell, whose luster is *akṛṣṇa*, that is, golden, and who is surrounded by His limbs and subsidiary parts (*aṅgas* and *upāṅgas*), His weapons and His associates.

Śrī Jīva (in the *Krama-sandarbha*): "*Tviṣā*, by His luster: the One who is not black — that is, golden — the intelligent worship Him. That He is golden follows by elimination from the verse: 'Your son appears in every age, accepting a body.

He has had three colors: white, red and yellow. Now He has come dark.' (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.36). It says that 'now' — in the Dvāpara famous as the age in which this avatāra descends — 'He has become black.' White and red are assigned to Satya and Tretā. Therefore the yellow color is spoken of as past with reference to earlier avatāras. Later it will be said that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the complete form [of God]. He is called a *yuga-avatāra* because all avatāras are contained within Him, and so all their purposes are fulfilled in Him alone. It is thus naturally understood that whenever Kṛṣṇa descends in Dvāpara, Śrī Gaura too descends in the following Kali. It follows that this Gaura is a special manifestation of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, for this rule admits no exception. The verse itself shows that He is such a manifestation by the qualifier *kṛṣṇa-varṇam*: He in whom are the two syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa' — that is, in whose name 'Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva' the two syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa' are used, revealing that He is Kṛṣṇa.

"In the Third Canto, in the words of Śrī Uddhava, in the verse beginning *samāhutāḥ*, there is the phrase *śriyaḥ savarṇena*, and the commentary on it says: 'He whose name has two syllables the same as [those of the name of] Śrī, that is, Rukmiṇī'; the expression *śriyaḥ savarṇo rukmī* is also found. Or else [*kṛṣṇa-varṇam* means]: He who describes (*varṇayati*) Kṛṣṇa — who Himself sings of Him, exulting in the memory of such pastimes of His own supreme bliss, and out of the greatest compassion teaches [this] to all people. Or else: He Himself is *akṛṣṇa*, golden, by *tviṣā*, His special beauty, and He teaches about Kṛṣṇa; the sense is that the mere sight of Him reveals Śrī Kṛṣṇa to all. Or else: though golden to all people, to special devotees He is, by *tviṣā* — a special manifestation — *kṛṣṇa-varṇa*, dark; that is, He is that very Śyāmasundara.[0] Therefore, since the very form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is manifest in Him, He is a special manifestation of Kṛṣṇa Himself. That is the sense.

"The verse makes clear that He is Bhagavān with the words *sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam*. His limbs (*aṅgas*) are so supremely charming that they themselves serve as *upāṅgas*, ornaments and the like. They are so powerful that they themselves are His weapons. They always dwell with Him alone, and so they themselves are His associates. Many great souls saw Him in just this way, again and again, and this is widely known among the people of Gauḍa, Varendra, Vaṅga, Utkala and other lands. Or else [by the other meaning of the particle *ca*]: His associates — the feet of the great soul Śrīmad Advaita Ācārya and others — are so intensely loved by Him that they are equal to His limbs, and He is present together with them. With what do they worship Him who is such? *Yajñaiḥ*, with the

articles of worship, according to the words '[where there are no] sacrifices to the Lord of sacrifice, no great festivals.'[0] Among these the verse specially names the *abhidheya* itself, *saṅkīrtana*: when many gather together and sing of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, rejoicing in that singing — [with sacrifices] in which this is foremost. And since the primacy of *saṅkīrtana* is seen only among those who have taken shelter of Him, it is clear that here the *abhidheya* is He Himself. That is why the *Sahasra-nāma* gives names that point to His avatāra: 'Golden in color, with a body like gold, beautifully formed, wearing armlets of sandal; the renunciant, self-controlled and peaceful' (see *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.49). Śrī Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, the crest-jewel of the most learned, also showed this: 'May the bee of my mind sink ever more deeply into the lotus feet of Him who has appeared under the name Kṛṣṇa Caitanya to reveal again His own *bhakti-yoga*, lost in the course of time.'[0]" So [it is said] in the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*.

Anubhāṣya.

"In which *yuga* and in what way does Bhagavān descend?" In answer to this question of King Nimi, Śrī Karabhājana speaks of the source of avatāras in the age of Kali and of how He is worshipped:

su-medhasaḥ (the intelligent) **tviṣā** (by His luster) **akṛṣṇam** (golden like lightning — the third color, yellow, which remains after white and red) **kṛṣṇa-varṇam** (Him who describes, who sings of Kṛṣṇa; or, Him in whom are these two syllables, "Kṛṣṇa") **sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam** (together with His limbs [*aṅgas*] — Nityānanda and Advaita; His subsidiary parts [*upāṅgas*] — Śrīvāsa and the other devotees; His weapons [*astras*] — the holy name of Hari and so on; and His associates [*pārṣadas*] — Gadādhara, Dāmodara Svarūpa and others) **saṅkīrtana-prāyaiḥ** (by singing *hari-kathā* and the names when many people gather together) **yajñaiḥ yajanti**.

শুন, ভাই, এই সব চৈতন্য-মহিমা ।
এই শ্লোকে কহে তাঁর মহিমার সীমা ॥ ৫২ ॥

śuna, bhāi, ei saba caitanya-mahimā
hear brothers this all of Caitanya the glory
ei śloke kahe tāṅra mahimāra sīmā
in this verse it tells His of glory the limit

52 Hear, brothers, all this glory of Caitanya. This verse tells the very limit of His glory.

*Explanation of the verse *kṛṣṇa-varṇam* —*

‘কৃষ্ণ’ এই দুই বর্ণ সদা যাঁর মুখে ।
অথবা, কৃষ্ণকে তিঁহো বর্ণে নিজ সুখে ॥ ৫৩ ॥

‘kṛṣṇa’ ei dui varṇa sadā yāṅra mukhe
Kṛṣṇa these two syllables always in whose mouth
athavā, kṛṣṇake tiṅho varṇe nija sukhe
or Kṛṣṇa He describes in His own joy

53 The two syllables “Kṛṣ-ṇa” are always in His mouth; or else, He describes Kṛṣṇa in His own joy.

কৃষ্ণবর্ণ-শব্দের অর্থ দুই ত’ প্রমাণ ।
কৃষ্ণ বিনু তাঁর মুখে নাহি আইসে আন ॥ ৫৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa-varṇa-śabdera artha dui ta’ pramāṇa
of the word kṛṣṇa-varṇa meanings two indeed established
kṛṣṇa vinu tāṅra mukhe nāhi āise āna
Kṛṣṇa except His into the mouth not comes anything else

54 These are the two established meanings of the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa*. Nothing but Kṛṣṇa ever comes to His lips.

কেহ তাঁরে বলে যদি কৃষ্ণ-বরণ ।
আর বিশেষণে তারে করে নিবারণ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

keha tāṅre bale yadi kṛṣṇa-varaṇa
anyone Him calls if dark in color
āra viśeṣaṇe tāre kare nivāraṇa
the next epithet that makes prevention

55 If anyone should call Him dark in color, the next epithet rules this out.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Someone might say, from the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa* in the original verse, that the One worshipped in the age of Kali is "Kṛṣṇa," dark. But the other qualifier, *tviṣākṛṣṇam*, does not allow that meaning.

দেহকান্ত্যে হয় তেঁহো অকৃষ্ণ-বরণ ।
অকৃষ্ণবরণে কহে পীতবরণ ॥ ৫৬ ॥

deha-kāntye haya teṅho akṛṣṇa-varaṇa
by the luster of the body is He not dark in color
akṛṣṇa-varaṇe kahe pīta-varaṇa
by not dark in color it means yellow in color

56 By the luster of His body He is not dark, and "not dark" means yellow.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second prayer to Śrī Caitanyadeva, verse 1)*

কলৌ যং বিদ্বাংসঃ স্ফুটমভিযজন্তে দ্যুতিভরা-
দকৃষ্ণাঙ্গং কৃষ্ণং মখবিধিভিরুৎকীর্ত্তনময়ৈঃ ।
উপাস্যঞ্চ প্রাহুর্যমখিলচতুর্থাশ্রমজুষাং
স দেবশ্চৈতন্যাকৃতিরতিতরাং নঃ কৃপয়তু ॥ ৫৭ ॥

kalau yaṁ vidvāṁsaḥ sphuṭam abhiyajante dyuti-bharād
in Kali whom the wise openly worship from the abundance of luster
akṛṣṇāṅgaṁ kṛṣṇaṁ makha-vidhibhir utkīrtana-mayaiḥ
not dark in body Kṛṣṇa with sacrificial rites consisting of loud chanting
upāsyaṁ ca prāhur yam akhila-caturthāśrama-juṣāṁ
the object of worship and they call whom of all who live in the fourth order
sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarāṁ naḥ kṛpayatu
that Lord in the form of Caitanya exceedingly to us may He show mercy

57 "In the age of Kali the wise openly worship Kṛṣṇa, whose body is not dark because of its abundant luster, with sacrificial rites that consist of loud chanting of His names. They declare Him the object of worship of all who live in the renounced order. May that Lord, who has appeared in the form of Caitanya, be abundantly merciful to us." (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka 1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa has become *akṛṣṇa* — that is, has taken a golden form — because He is overflowing with luster, the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhikā. In the age of Kali the learned openly worship Him with a sacrifice made of *kīrtana*. He is the only object of worship for those who serve in the fourth *āśrama*, the *paramahaṁsas* within *sannyāsa*. May that Supreme Person in the form of Caitanya bestow His mercy on us in abundance.

Anubhāṣya.

vidvāṁsaḥ (the learned) **sphuṭam** (openly) **dyuti-bharāt** (from the abundance of His luster) **akṛṣṇāṅgam** (golden, of yellow color) **kṛṣṇam utkīrtana-mayaiḥ** (resting on the devotion called loud *kīrtana*) **makha-vidhibhiḥ** (by the rites of the sacrifice of the name) **kalau abhiyajante**, **yaṁ ca akhila-caturthāśrama-juṣām** (of all mendicant monks) **upāsyam** (worthy of worship) **prāhuḥ**, **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ naḥ** (us) **atitarām** (exceedingly) **kṛpayatu**.

The effulgence of Brahman destroys darkness —

প্রত্যক্ষ তাঁহার তপ্তকাঞ্চনের দ্যুতি ।
যাঁহার ছটায় নাশে অজ্ঞান-তমস্ততি ॥ ৫৮ ॥

pratyakṣa tāṅhāra tapta-kāñcanera dyuti
visibly His of molten gold the luster
yāṅhāra chaṭāya nāśe ajñāna-tamastati
by whose radiance is destroyed of ignorance the darkness

58 His luster of molten gold is plain to see, and its radiance dispels the darkness of ignorance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tamas-tati: the spreading darkness of ignorance.

জীবের কল্মষ-তমো নাশ করিবারে ।
অঙ্গ-উপাঙ্গ-নাম নানা অস্ত্র ধরে ॥ ৫৯ ॥

jīvera kalmaṣa-tamo nāśa karibāre
of the souls of sin the darkness destruction to make
aṅga-upāṅga-nāma nānā astra dhare
limbs sub-limbs the Name various weapons He holds

59 To destroy the darkness of the souls' sins, He bears various weapons: His limbs (*aṅga*), His sub-limbs (*upāṅga*) and the Holy Name.

*What is called darkness, or *kalmaṣa* —*

ভক্তির বিরোধী কর্ম্ম, ধর্ম্ম বা অধর্ম্ম ।
তাহার 'কল্মষ' নাম, সেই মহাতমঃ ॥ ৬০ ॥

bhaktira virodhī karma, dharma vā adharma
to devotion opposed action piety or impiety
tāhāra 'kalmaṣa' nāma, sei mahā-tamaḥ
its kalmaṣa the name that great darkness

60 Any action opposed to devotion, whether pious or impious, is called *kalmaṣa*, sin. That is the great darkness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Be it *dharma* or *adharma*, whenever an action is opposed to devotion, it is called *kalmaṣa* — and that is the great darkness.

বাহু তুলি' হরি বলি' প্রেমদৃষ্ট্যে চায় ।
করিয়া কল্মষ নাশ প্রেমেতে ভাসায় ॥ ৬১ ॥

bāhu tuli' hari bali' prema-dṛṣṭye cāya
arms raising Hari saying with a glance of love He looks
kariyā kalmaṣa nāśa premete bhāsāya
making of sin destruction in love He floods

61 Raising His arms and calling "Hari!", He looks on all with eyes full of love. He destroys their sins and floods them with love.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second prayer to Śrī Caitanyadeva, verse 8)*

স্মিতালোকঃ শোকং হরতি জগতাং যস্য পরিতো
গিরাম্ভ প্রারম্ভঃ কুশলপটলীং পল্লবয়তি ৷
পদালম্ভঃ কং বা প্রণয়তি ন হি প্রেমনিবহং
স দেবশ্চৈতন্যাকৃতিরতিতরাং নঃ কৃপয়তু ॥ ৬২ ॥

smitālokaḥ śokaṁ harati jagatāṁ yasya parito
the smiling glance sorrow takes away of the world whose entirely
girāṁ tu prārambhaḥ kuśala-paṭalīṁ pallavayati
of words and the beginning of good fortunes the multitude makes blossom
padālambhaḥ kaṁ vā praṇayati na hi prema-nivahaṁ
the touch of the feet what indeed brings forth not surely of love a flood
sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarāṁ naḥ kṛpayatu
that Lord in the form of Caitanya exceedingly to us may He show mercy

62 "His smiling glance takes away all the sorrow of the world, and the mere beginning of His words makes good fortune blossom in abundance. What flood of love does the touch of His feet not bring forth? May that Lord, who has appeared in the form of Caitanya, be abundantly merciful to us." (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka 8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

His smiling glance completely takes away the sorrow of the world. As soon as He begins to speak, the creeper of devotion — the creeper of every blessing — puts forth new leaves. Shelter at His feet reveals all the secrets of *prema*. May that Supreme Person in the form of Caitanya bestow His mercy on us in abundance.

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (of Caitanyadeva) **smitālokaḥ** (the glance with a gentle smile) **jagatām** (of all living beings) **paritaḥ** (completely) **śokam** (sorrow, want) **harati** (destroys), **girāṁ prārambhaḥ** (the beginning of His words) **tu kuśala-paṭalīm** (the series of blessings) **pallavayati** (unfolds), **padālambhaḥ** (shelter at His feet) **kaṁ vā prema-nivaham** (all *prema*) **na hi praṇayati** (does not bestow), **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ naḥ** (us) **atitarāṁ kṛpayatu**.

*Whoever sees Gaura is freed of sin and attains *prema* —*

শ্রীঅঙ্গ, শ্রীমুখ যেই করে দরশন ।
তার পাপক্ষয় হয়, পায় প্রেমধন ॥ ৬৩ ॥

śrī-aṅga, śrī-mukha yei kare daraśana
the beautiful body the beautiful face whoever makes seeing
tāra pāpa-kṣaya haya, pāya prema-dhana
his of sins destruction occurs he obtains the treasure of love

63 Whoever sees His beautiful body and His beautiful face is freed from sin and receives the treasure of love.

*Other avatāras have weapons and armies, but the Gaura-avatāra has devotees and *saṅkīrtana* —*

অন্য অবতারে সব সৈন্য-শস্ত্র সঙ্গে ।
চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণের সৈন্য অঙ্গ-উপাঙ্গে ॥ ৬৪ ॥

anya avatāre saba sainya-śastra saṅge
in other avatāras all soldiers and weapons along
caitanya-kṛṣṇera sainya aṅga-upāṅge
of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa the army limbs and sub-limbs

64 In His other avatāras the Lord came with soldiers and weapons, but the army of Kṛṣṇa as Caitanya is His limbs and sub-limbs.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the first *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 1)*

সদোপাস্যঃ শ্রীমান্ ধৃতমনুজকায়ৈঃ প্রণয়িতাং
বহদ্ভির্গীর্বাণৈর্গিরিশপরমেষ্ঠিপ্রভৃতিভিঃ ।
স্বভক্তেভ্যঃ শুদ্ধাং নিজভজনমুদ্রামুপদিশন্
স চৈতন্যঃ কিং মে পুনরপি দৃশোর্যাস্যতি পদম্ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

sadopāsyaḥ śrīmān dhṛta-manuja-kāyaiḥ praṇayitāṁ
ever worshipable the beautiful one who had taken human bodies love
vahadbhir gīr-vāṇair giriśa-parameṣṭhi-prabhṛtibhiḥ
bearing by the gods Śiva and Brahmā headed by
sva-bhaktebhyaḥ śuddhāṁ nija-bhajana-mudrām upadiśan
to His own devotees pure the way of worshipping Him teaching
sa caitanyaḥ kiṁ me punar api dṛśor yāsyati padam
that Caitanya will my again also of the eyes come within the range

65 "The gods headed by Śiva and Brahmā, who took human bodies and bore love for Him, always worship Him. To His own devotees He teaches the pure way of worshipping Him. Will that beautiful Caitanya ever again come within the range of my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka 1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Caitanyadeva is lovingly honored by Śiva, Brahmā and the other gods, who have taken human bodies, and all living beings always worship Him. He teaches His devotees the pure way of worshipping Him. Will that Caitanyadeva come before my eyes again?

Anubhāṣya.
praṇayitāṁ vahadbhiḥ (bearing love, that is, intent on nourishing their own attachment) **dhṛta-manuja-kāyaiḥ** (who have taken human bodies) **giriśa-parameṣṭhi-prabhṛtibhiḥ** (Śiva, the four-headed [Brahmā] and others) **gīr-vāṇaiḥ** (by the gods) **sadā** (eternally) **upāsyaḥ** (worshipped) **sva-bhaktebhyaḥ** (to His own intimates — Svarūpa, Rāmānanda and others) **śuddhām** (pure — free of other desires, not covered by *karma*, *jñāna* and the like) **nija-bhajana-mudrām** (the way of worshipping Him) **upadiśan saḥ caitanyaḥ kiṁ punaḥ api me** (my) **dṛśoḥ padaṁ yāsyati** (will reach)?

আঙ্গোপাঙ্গ অস্ত্র করে স্বকার্য্যসাধন ।
'অঙ্গ' শব্দের অর্থ আর শুন দিয়া মন ॥ ৬৬ ॥

āṅgopāṅga astra kare sva-kārya-sādhana
limbs and sub-limbs weapons make of their own task accomplishment
'aṅga' śabdera artha āra śuna diyā mana
aṅga of the word the meaning another hear giving the mind

66 His limbs and sub-limbs are the weapons that accomplish His work. Now hear attentively another meaning of the word *aṅga*.

‘অঙ্গ’ শব্দে অংশ কহে শাস্ত্র-পরমাণ ।
অঙ্গের অবয়ব ‘উপাঙ্গ’ ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ৬৭ ॥

‘aṅga’ śabde aṁśa kahe śāstra-paramāṇa
by the word aṅga a portion says scriptural evidence
aṅgera avayava ‘upāṅga’ vyākhyāna
of the aṅga a part upāṅga is explained

67 According to the evidence of scripture, the word *aṅga* means a plenary portion (*aṁśa*), and *upāṅga* is explained as a part of that portion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Besides the meaning already explained, the word *aṅga* has another: *aṅga* means *aṁśa*, a part. *Paramāṇa* is the same as *pramāṇa*, evidence. The parts of an *aṅga* are the *upāṅgas*.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 14)*

নারায়ণস্ত্বং ন হি সর্ব্বদেহিনা-
মাত্মাস্যধীশাখিললোকসাক্ষী ।
নারায়ণোঽঙ্গং নরভূ-জলায়না-
ত্তচ্চাপি সত্যং ন তবৈব মায়া ॥ ৬৮ ॥

nārāyaṇas tvaṁ na hi sarva-dehinām
Nārāyaṇa You not indeed of all embodied beings
ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī
the Self You are O Lord of all worlds the witness
nārāyaṇo ’ṅgaṁ nara-bhū-jalāyanāt
Nārāyaṇa Your portion of Nara born the water as resting place
tac cāpi satyaṁ na tavaiva māyā
that and also true not Your indeed māyā

68 “O Lord, are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are the Self of all embodied beings and the witness of all the worlds. The one called Nārāyaṇa because His resting place is the water born of Nara is Your portion. And that portion too is real; it is not Your māyā.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.14)

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.30.

The meaning of this verse —

জলশায়ী অন্তর্য্যামী যেই নারায়ণ ।
সেহো তোমার অংশ, তুমি মূল নারায়ণ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

jala-śāyī antar-yāmī yei nārāyaṇa
lying on the water the indwelling Lord who Nārāyaṇa
seho tomāra aṁśa, tumi mūla nārāyaṇa
He too Your portion You the original Nārāyaṇa

69 The Nārāyaṇa who lies on the water and dwells within all is Your portion. You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

‘অঙ্গ’-শব্দে অংশ কহে, সেহো সত্য হয় ।
মায়াকার্য্য নহে — সব চিদানন্দময় ॥ ৭০ ॥

‘aṅga’-śabde aṁśa kahe, seho satya haya
by the word aṅga a portion it says that too true is
māyā-kārya nahe — saba cid-ānanda-maya
of māyā a product not all full of spirit and bliss

70 Here the word *aṅga* means a portion, and that portion too is real. It is not a product of māyā; it is wholly spiritual and full of bliss.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The word *aṅga* refers to the three *puruṣas*, beginning with Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, who are *aṁśas*. They are full of spirit and bliss, the true Īśvara, the Lord — not *tattvas* created by *māyā*. Therefore Advaita and Nityānanda are the Lord's two *aṅgas*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the realm of *māyā*, *māyā* divides an object and it becomes a part. With *viṣṇu-tattva* it is not so: it cannot come under the control of *māyā*. Therefore, though He is a part, He is not divided either in His nature as Viṣṇu or in His substance. The example of a lamp shows this: another lamp is lit from the original lamp, yet in substance they do not differ. In the same way all the *viṣṇu-tattvas* appear from Baladeva, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa*, or *vilāsa*, of Kṛṣṇa, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). Their pastimes differ, but in substance they are one. The separated parts (*vibhinnāṁśa*), however — Brahmā and Śiva — can come under the control of *māyā*, and therefore they have acquired a capacity for transformation. All those Viṣṇus are full of spirit and bliss, and all are masters of *māyā*: *māyā* has no power over them. On other *tattvas* *māyā* does act. As curd is a transformation of milk, so are *śambhu-tattva* and the rest.

The two generals —

অদ্বৈত, নিত্যানন্দ — চৈতন্যের দুই অঙ্গ ।
অঙ্গের অবয়বগণ কহিয়ে উপাঙ্গ ॥ ৭১ ॥

advaita, nityānanda — caitanyera dui aṅga
Advaita Nityānanda of Caitanya two limbs
aṅgera avayava-gaṇa kahiye upāṅga
of the limbs the parts all I call sub-limbs

71 Advaita and Nityānanda are the two limbs (*aṅga*) of Caitanya, and I call the parts of these limbs His sub-limbs (*upāṅga*).

অঙ্গোপাঙ্গ তীক্ষ্ণ অস্ত্র প্রভুর সহিতে ।
সেই সব অস্ত্র হয় পাষণ্ড দলিতে ॥ ৭২ ॥

aṅgopāṅga tīkṣṇa astra prabhura sahite
limbs and sub-limbs sharp weapons the Lord with
sei saba astra haya pāṣaṇḍa dalite
those all weapons are the unbelievers to crush

72 His limbs and sub-limbs are sharp weapons that are always with the Lord, and all these weapons serve to crush the unbelievers (*pāṣaṇḍa*).

Anubhāṣya.

Pāṣaṇḍa: those who imagine that *śiva-tattva* and the like, which are subject to *māyā*, are equal to *viṣṇu-tattva*, the master of *māyā*. They do not realize that Bhagavān's pastimes are eternal, and they regard even the eternal truth of devotion as mere activity, divided by time and impermanent. Viṣṇu and His own associates labor to rid such *pāṣaṇḍīs* of their wicked intelligence.

The two Viṣṇus are the two generals —

নিত্যানন্দ গোসাঞি সাক্ষাৎ হলধর ।
অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য গোসাঞি সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর ॥ ৭৩ ॥

nityānanda gosāñi sākṣāt haladhara
Nityānanda Gosāñi directly the holder of the plow
advaita ācārya gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara
Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi directly the Lord

73 Lord Nityānanda is Haladhara Himself, the bearer of the plow, and Advaita Ācārya is the Lord Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

That is, He is directly an avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

*The devotees are the army, and *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa is the weapon —*

শ্রীবাসাদি পারিষদ সৈন্য সঙ্গে লঞা ।
দুই সেনাপতি বুলেন কীর্ত্তন করিয়া ॥ ৭৪ ॥

śrīvāsādi pāriṣada sainya saṅge lañā
Śrīvāsa and others associates army along taking
dui senā-pati bulena kīrtana kariyā
two generals go about kīrtana performing

74 Taking with them the army of associates headed by Śrīvāsa, these two generals go about performing *kīrtana*.

পাষণ্ডদলনবানা নিত্যানন্দ রায় ।
আচার্য্য-হুঙ্কারে পাপ-পাষণ্ডী পলায় ॥ ৭৫ ॥

pāṣaṇḍa-dalana-vānā nityānanda rāya
of the unbelievers crushing whose vow Nityānanda Rāya
ācārya-huṅkāre pāpa-pāṣaṇḍī palāya
at the Ācārya's roar sin and the unbelievers flee

75 Nityānanda Rāya is vowed to crush the unbelievers, and at the roar of Advaita Ācārya sin and the unbelievers flee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bānā: a sign; an instrument like the *tūrī* or *bherī* (trumpet or kettledrum), whose sound announces that the *pāṣaṇḍīs*, the godless, will be crushed.

*Gaurasundara is the very father of *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa —*

সঙ্কীর্ত্তন-প্রবর্ত্তক শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
সঙ্কীর্ত্তন-যজ্ঞে তাঁরে ভজে, সেই ধন্য ॥ ৭৬ ॥

saṅkīrtana-pravartaka śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
of saṅkīrtana the founder Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
saṅkīrtana-yajñe tāṅre bhaje, sei dhanya
by the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana Him worships that one fortunate

76 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the founder of saṅkīrtana. Whoever worships Him by the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana is truly fortunate.

*As a father is pleased when his son is honored, so Gaura is pleased by *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa —*

সেই ত' সুমেধা, আর কুবুদ্ধি সংসার ।
সর্ব্ব-যজ্ঞ হৈতে কৃষ্ণনামযজ্ঞ সার ॥ ৭৭ ॥

sei ta' sumedhā, āra kubuddhi saṁsāra
he indeed intelligent and foolish the world
sarva-yajña haite kṛṣṇa-nāma-yajña sāra
of all sacrifices than the sacrifice of Kṛṣṇa's name the essence

77 Such a person is truly intelligent, while the rest of the world lacks good sense. Of all sacrifices, the sacrifice of chanting Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence.

To think the Lord in the form of the holy name equal to material activities is godlessness —

কোটি অশ্বমেধ এক কৃষ্ণ নাম সম ।
যেই কহে, সে পাষণ্ডী, দণ্ডে তারে যম ॥ ৭৮ ॥

koṭi aśvamedha eka kṛṣṇa nāma sama
ten million horse sacrifices one of Kṛṣṇa name equal
yei kahe, se pāṣaṇḍī, daṇḍe tāre yama
whoever says he an unbeliever punishes him Yama

78 Whoever says that ten million horse sacrifices equal a single name of Kṛṣṇa is an unbeliever, and Yama punishes him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who worships Kṛṣṇa Caitanya with the sacrifice of *saṅkīrtana* is truly *sumedhā*, that is, intelligent. Those in this world who do not worship Him in this way are utterly foolish. The sacrifice of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence of all sacrifices. Ten million *aśvamedha* sacrifices cannot be compared with a single name of Kṛṣṇa. One who thinks them equal is a *pāṣaṇḍī*, and Yama punishes him.

Anubhāṣya.
"To consider [the name] equal to all auspicious activities — *dharma*, vows, renunciation, sacrifices and the like — is also a blunder." This eighth offense against the holy name must be avoided in every way. "Giving away ten million cows during a solar eclipse, living for a *kalpa* by the waters of the Gaṅgā at Prayāga, performing ten thousand sacrifices, giving away as much gold as there is in Mount Meru — none of this equals even a hundredth part of glorifying Govinda."

'ভাগবতসন্দর্ভ'-গ্রন্থের মঙ্গলাচরণে ।
এ-শ্লোক জীবগোসাঞি করিয়াছেন ব্যাখ্যানে ॥ ৭৯ ॥

'bhāgavata-sandarbha'-granthera maṅgalācaraṇe
Bhāgavata-sandarbha of the book in the invocation
e-śloka jīva-gosāñi kariyāchena vyākhyāne
this verse Jīva Gosāñi has made in explanation

79 In the invocation of his book *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī has explained this verse:

*(*Tattva-sandarbha*, verse 2)*

অন্তঃকৃষ্ণং বহির্গৌরং দর্শিতাঙ্গাদিবৈভবম্ ।
কলৌ সঙ্কীর্ত্তনাদ্যৈঃ স্ম কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যমাশ্রিতাঃ ॥ ৮০ ॥

antaḥ kṛṣṇaṁ bahir gauraṁ
inwardly Kṛṣṇa outwardly golden
darśitāṅgādi-vaibhavam
who has displayed His limbs and so on the splendor
kalau saṅkīrtanādyaiḥ sma
in Kali by saṅkīrtana and other means indeed
kṛṣṇa-caitanyam āśritāḥ
Kṛṣṇa Caitanya have taken shelter

80 "In the age of Kali, through saṅkīrtana and other practices, we have taken shelter of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa within and golden without, and who has displayed the splendor of His limbs and sub-limbs." (Bhāgavata-sandarbha 1.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the age of Kali we take shelter, through *saṅkīrtana* and the other limbs [of devotion], of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. He is marked by the splendor of His *aṅgas*, *upāṅgas* and the rest; within He is Kṛṣṇa Himself, and without He is Gaura.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī placed the verse *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* in the *maṅgalācaraṇa* of the *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, or *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. Similar to it is his own verse, *antaḥ kṛṣṇaṁ bahir gauram*. This is the second verse of that *maṅgalācaraṇa*, and it merely explains Karabhājana's verse in the *Bhāgavatam*. Its meaning is explained at the beginning of the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*, the supplementary commentary (*anuvyākhyā*) on the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*.

antaḥ-kṛṣṇam (Him within whom, in the depth of whose heart, is Kṛṣṇa; Him in whom the mood of the lover [*nāgara*] dwelling in Kṛṣṇa's heart is covered by the

mood of Rādhā's heart) **bahir gauram** (Him whose form is yellow with the rays of His bodily luster) **darśitāṅgādi-vaibhavam** (Him who has shown, revealed, the splendor of His limbs, subsidiary parts, weapons and associates) **kṛṣṇa-caitanyam kalau saṅkīrtanādyaiḥ** (by the sacrifice of *nāma-kīrtana* and the rest) **vayam āśritāḥ sma**.

উপপুরাণেহ শুনি শ্রীকৃষ্ণবচন ।
কৃপা করি' ব্যাস প্রতি করিয়াছেন কথন ॥ ৮১ ॥

upa-purāṇeha śuni śrī-kṛṣṇa-vacana
in the Upapurāṇas too we hear Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words
kṛpā kari' vyāsa prati kariyāchena kathana
mercy showing Vyāsa to He has made a statement

81 In the Upapurāṇas too we hear the words that Śrī Kṛṣṇa mercifully spoke to Vyāsa:

(In an Upapurāṇa)

অহমেব ক্বচিদ্ব্রহ্মন্ সন্ন্যাসাশ্রমমাশ্রিতঃ ।
হরিভক্তিং গ্রাহয়ামি কলৌ পাপহতান্নরান্ ॥ ৮২ ॥

aham eva kvacid brahman
I Myself sometimes O brāhmaṇa
sannyāsāśramam āśritaḥ
the order of sannyāsa having accepted
hari-bhaktiṁ grāhayāmi
devotion to Hari I cause to accept
kalau pāpa-hatān narān
in Kali by sin stricken people

82 "O brāhmaṇa, sometimes I Myself accept the renounced order (*sannyāsa*) and lead the people of Kali, stricken by sin, to accept devotion to Hari."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O *brāhmaṇa*, in a certain special Kali-yuga I shall accept the *āśrama* of *sannyāsa* and give *hari-bhakti* to people stricken by sin.

Anubhāṣya.
This verse is found in one of the Upapurāṇas.

he brahman, **aham** (Bhagavān) **eva kvacit kalau** (in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*) **sannyāsāśramam** (the fourth *āśrama*) **āśritaḥ san** (having accepted) **pāpa-hatān narān hari-bhaktiṁ grāhayāmi** (I shall give).

The evidence of scripture that Gaurasundara is Bhagavān Himself —

ভাগবত, ভারতশাস্ত্র, আগম, পুরাণ ।
চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণ-অবতার-প্রকট প্রমাণ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

bhāgavata, bhārata-śāstra, āgama, purāṇa
the Bhāgavatam the Mahābhārata the Āgamas the Purāṇas
caitanya-kṛṣṇa-avatāra-prakaṭa pramāṇa
of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa of the descent manifest evidence

83 The Bhāgavatam, the Mahābhārata, the Āgamas and the Purāṇas give clear evidence of Kṛṣṇa's descent as Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Many statements prove that Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is a direct avatāra. In the *Bhāgavatam* there are the words *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* (“He who utters the name of Kṛṣṇa, yet is not dark”), *āsan varṇās trayaḥ* (“there were three colors”), *channaḥ kalau* (“hidden in the age of Kali”) and others. In the *Mahābhārata* there are the words *sambhavāmi yuge yuge* (“I appear in every *yuga*”), *sannyāsa-kṛc chamaḥ śāntaḥ* (“the renunciant, self-controlled and peaceful”) and others. In the Vedas there are *mahān prabhur vai puruṣaḥ* (“the Puruṣa is indeed the great Lord”), *yadā paśyaḥ paśyate rukma-varṇam* (“when the seer sees the golden One”) and others. In the Tantras that follow the Āgamas there are many statements such as *māyāpure bhaviṣyāmi śacī-sutaḥ* (“I shall be the son of Śacī in Māyāpura”). And in the Upapurāṇa there are the words *aham eva* (“I Myself”) and what follows.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 2.22.

Direct evidence of this —

প্রত্যক্ষে দেখহ নানা প্রকট প্রভাব ।
অলৌকিক কর্ম্ম, অলৌকিক অনুভাব ॥ ৮৪ ॥

pratyakṣe dekhaha nānā prakaṭa prabhāva
directly see various manifest powers
alaukika karma, alaukika anubhāva
extraordinary deeds extraordinary signs of ecstasy

84 And you can see with your own eyes His many manifest powers: His extraordinary deeds and His extraordinary signs of ecstasy (*anubhāva*).

Anubhāṣya.

Gaura is Kṛṣṇa, and this is the aim of the scriptures. One can understand it directly as well: by seeing with one's own senses what Śrī Mahāprabhu's pastimes can do, His superhuman conduct and the variety of His superhuman glory and power.[0]

*The *adhokṣaja-tattva*, the Truth beyond the senses, cannot be seen with eyes that crave enjoyment —*

দেখিয়া না দেখে যত অভক্তের গণ ।
উলূকে না দেখে যেন সূর্য্যের কিরণ ॥ ৮৫ ॥

dekhiyā nā dekhe yata abhaktera gaṇa
seeing not see all of the nondevotees the crowd
ulūke nā dekhe yena sūryera kiraṇa
the owl not sees as of the sun the rays

85 Yet the nondevotees see all this and do not see it, just as the owl does not see the rays of the sun.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ulūka: a kind of owl that is blind by day. Unable to see the rays of the sun, it cannot admit that the sun exists.

*(Ālavandāru Yāmunācārya, *Stotra-ratna*, verse 15)*

ত্বাং শীলরূপচরিতৈঃ পরমপ্রকৃষ্টৈঃ
সত্ত্বেন সাত্ত্বিকতয়া প্রবলৈশ্চ শাস্ত্রৈঃ ৷
প্রখ্যাতদৈবপরমার্থবিদাং মতৈশ্চ
নৈবাসুরপ্রকৃতয়ঃ প্রভবন্তি বোদ্ধুম্ ॥ ৮৬ ॥

tvāṁ śīla-rūpa-caritaiḥ parama-prakṛṣṭaiḥ
You by character, form and deeds supremely excellent
sattvena sāttvikatayā prabalaiś ca śāstraiḥ
by strength by pure goodness mighty and by the scriptures
prakhyāta-daiva-paramārtha-vidāṁ mataiś ca
of the renowned godly knowers of the highest truth by the views and
naivāsura-prakṛtayaḥ prabhavanti boddhum
not at all those of demonic nature are able to understand

86 "Your character, form and deeds are supremely excellent, and Your strength and pure goodness, the mighty scriptures and the views of renowned godly knowers of the highest truth all make You known. Yet those of demonic nature can never understand You." (Stotra-ratna 12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, Vyāsa and the other devotees who know the highest truth and the truth of Your avatāras are able to know You: through the powerful *sāttvika* scriptures they discern Your character, Your form, Your deeds and Your supremely *sāttvika* nature. But living beings of demoniac nature, endowed with the qualities of *rajas* and *tamas*, are unable to know You.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Yāmunācārya, the guru and *parama-guru* of Śrī Rāmānujācārya, who is also called Ālavandāru, describes Bhagavān's glory and majesty in verses 15 and 18 of his *Stotra-ratna*:

he bhagavan, **parama-prakṛṣṭaiḥ** (most excellent) **śīla-rūpa-caritaiḥ** (by His character, forms and deeds) **sattvena** (by superhuman power) **sāttvikatayā** (by the predominance of *sattva*) **prabalaiḥ śāstraiḥ prakhyāta-daiva-paramārtha-vidām** (of the renowned knowers of the divine and of the highest truth) **mataiḥ ca**

āsura-prakṛtayaḥ (the wicked, the enemies of the devotees) **tvāṁ boddhum** (to know) **na samarthāḥ bhavanti**.

But the devotee's love conquers the Unconquerable and makes the Unlimited measurable —

আপনা লুকাইতে কৃষ্ণ নানা যত্ন করে ।
তথাপি তাঁহার ভক্ত জানয়ে তাঁহারে ॥ ৮৭ ॥

āpanā lukāite kṛṣṇa nānā yatna kare
Himself to hide Kṛṣṇa various efforts makes
tathāpi tāṅhāra bhakta jānaye tāṅhāre
nevertheless His devotee knows Him

87 Kṛṣṇa makes many efforts to hide Himself, yet His devotee knows Him.

*(Ālavandāru Yāmunācārya, *Stotra-ratna*, verse 18)*

উল্লঙ্ঘিতত্রিবিধসীমসমাতিশায়ি-
সম্ভাবনং তব পরিব্রঢ়িমস্বভাবম্ ।
মায়াবলেন ভবতাপি নিগুহ্যমানং
পশ্যন্তি কেচিদনিশং ত্বদনন্যভাবাঃ ॥ ৮৮ ॥

ullaṅghita-trividha-sīma-samātiśāyi-
which transcends the threefold limits equal or superior
sambhāvanaṁ tava parivraḍhima-svabhāvam
the possibility of Your of supremacy the nature
māyā-balena bhavatāpi niguhyamānaṁ
by the power of māyā by You even being hidden
paśyanti kecid aniśaṁ tvad-ananya-bhāvāḥ
see some constantly devoted to You alone

88 “Your supreme nature transcends the three kinds of limits, and nothing can be equal to it or greater. Though You hide it by the power of Your own māyā (Yogamāyā), some, devoted to You alone, see it at all times.” (Stotra-ratna 13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, everything is confined by three limits — space, time and thought. But Your hidden nature has no equal and none above it, and so it exists beyond those three limits. By the power of Your *māyā* You conceal this nature, yet Your exclusive devotees are always able to see You.

Anubhāṣya.

ullaṅghita-trividha-sīma-samātiśāyi-sambhāvanam (that which oversteps, surpasses, the limits of the three — space, time and substance — and even the possibility of an equal or a superior) **bhavatā māyā-balena** (by the power of Your *yogamāyā*) **nigūhyamānam api tava parivraḍhima-svabhāvam** (the nature, the *svarūpa*, of Your lordship) **kecit tvad-ananya-bhāvāḥ** (those whose feeling is directed to You alone — the *ekāntins*, the exclusive devotees) **aniśam** (unceasingly) **paśyanti**.

*The *adhokṣaja-tattva* is attained through devotion, not reached by knowledge born of the senses —*

অসুরস্বভাবে কৃষ্ণে কভু নাহি জানে ।
লুকাইতে নারে কৃষ্ণ ভক্তজন-স্থানে ॥ ৮৯ ॥

asura-svabhāve kṛṣṇe kabhu nāhi jāne
by demonic nature Kṛṣṇa ever not know
lukāite nāre kṛṣṇa bhakta-jana-sthāne
to hide cannot Kṛṣṇa from His devotees the people

89 Those of demonic nature never know Kṛṣṇa, but Kṛṣṇa cannot hide from His devotees.

*(*Padma Purāṇa*)*

দ্বৌ ভূতসর্গৌ লোকেঽস্মিন্ দৈব আসুর এব চ ।
বিষ্ণুভক্তঃ স্মৃতো দৈব আসুরস্তদ্বিপর্য্যয়ঃ ॥ ৯০ ॥

dvau bhūta-sargau loke 'smin
two of beings creations in the world this
daiva āsura eva ca
divine demonic indeed and
viṣṇu-bhaktaḥ smṛto daiva
a devotee of Viṣṇu is known as divine
āsuras tad-viparyayaḥ
demonic his opposite

90 "In this world there are two kinds of created beings, the divine and the demonic. A devotee of Viṣṇu is called divine, and the demonic is his opposite." (Padma Purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In this world living beings are created of two kinds, *daiva*, the godly, and *āsura*, the demoniac. The devotees of Viṣṇu are *daiva*, and those who are not devoted to Viṣṇu are their opposite, that is, demoniac by nature.

Anubhāṣya.
asmin loke daivaḥ āsuraḥ ca eva dvau bhūta-sargau (two kinds of created beings): **viṣṇu-bhaktaḥ** (the servant of Hari) **daivaḥ smṛtaḥ**, **tad-viparyayaḥ** (one absorbed in enjoyment within *māyā*) **āsuraḥ** (a person of material nature) **eva**.

The Ācārya is the avatāra of a devotee, and therefore he has the power to make Gaura descend —

আচার্য্য গোসাঞি প্রভুর ভক্ত-অবতার ।
কৃষ্ণ-অবতার-হেতু যাঁহার হুঙ্কার ॥ ৯১ ॥

ācārya gosāñi prabhura bhakta-avatāra
the Ācārya Gosāñi the Lord's devotee-avatāra
kṛṣṇa-avatāra-hetu yāṅhāra huṅkāra
of Kṛṣṇa's descent the cause whose roar

91 Advaita Ācārya is the Lord's avatāra as a devotee, and His roar caused Kṛṣṇa to descend.

Before the avatāra of the original form, His servants, the elders, appear —

কৃষ্ণ যদি পৃথিবীতে করেন অবতার ।
প্রথমে করেন গুরুবর্গের সঞ্চার ॥ ৯২ ॥

kṛṣṇa yadi pṛthivīte karena avatāra
Kṛṣṇa when on earth makes descent
prathame karena guru-vargera sañcāra
first He makes of His elders the appearance

92 Whenever Kṛṣṇa descends on earth, He first sends His elders.

পিতা মাতা গুরু আদি যত মান্যগণ ।
প্রথমে করেন সবার পৃথিবীতে জনম ॥ ৯৩ ॥

pitā mātā guru ādi yata mānya-gaṇa
father mother guru and so on all the respected ones
prathame karena sabāra pṛthivīte janama
first He makes of all on earth the birth

93 First He has all those He honors, His father, mother, guru and others, take birth on earth.

মাধব-ঈশ্বর-পুরী, শচী, জগন্নাথ ।
অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য প্রকট হৈলা সেই সাথ ॥ ৯৪ ॥

mādhava-īśvara-purī, śacī, jagannātha
Mādhava Īśvara Purī Śacī Jagannātha
advaita ācārya prakaṭa hailā sei sātha
Advaita Ācārya manifest became with them

94 Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī, Śacī and Jagannātha Miśra appeared, and Advaita Ācārya appeared along with them.

The state of society before the Lord's descent —

প্রকটিয়া দেখে আচার্য্য সকল সংসার ।
কৃষ্ণভক্তিগন্ধহীন বিষয়-ব্যবহার ॥ ৯৫ ॥

prakaṭiyā dekhe ācārya sakala saṁsāra
having appeared sees the Ācārya the whole world
kṛṣṇa-bhakti gandha-hīna viṣaya-vyavahāra
of devotion to Kṛṣṇa without a trace worldly dealings

95 When Advaita Ācārya appeared, He saw the whole world absorbed in worldly affairs, without a trace of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

The pious and the sinner alike enjoy the senses and alike suffer the disease of worldly existence —

কেহ পাপে, কেহ পুণ্যে করে বিষয়-ভোগ ।
ভক্তিগন্ধ নাহি, যাতে যায় ভবরোগ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

keha pāpe, keha puṇye kare viṣaya-bhoga
some in sin some in piety make sense enjoyment
bhakti-gandha nāhi, yāte yāya bhava-roga
of devotion a trace none by which goes away the disease of worldly existence

96 Some enjoyed the world through sin and some through piety, but no one had even a trace of devotion, which cures the disease of worldly existence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Before Bhagavān Himself descends, He sends the elders — that is, He has them take birth on earth. Together with other elders appeared Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, Śrī Īśvara Purī, Śrī Śacī, Śrī Jagannātha and Śrī Advaita Ācārya. Having appeared, the Ācārya saw that the whole world was entangled in sin and piety and devoid of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. Living beings were enjoying the objects of the senses, but they did not mix with this the devotion to Kṛṣṇa that cures the disease of worldly existence.

The Ācārya reflects on showing mercy to living beings —

লোকগতি দেখি' আচার্য্য করুণ-হৃদয় ।
বিচার করেন, লোকের কৈছে হিত হয় ॥ ৯৭ ॥

loka-gati dekhi' ācārya karuṇa-hṛdaya
the state of the people seeing the Ācārya compassionate at heart
vicāra karena, lokera kaiche hita haya
consideration makes of the people how welfare will be

97 Seeing the condition of the people, the compassionate Ācārya considered how they could be truly benefited.

আপনি শ্রীকৃষ্ণ যদি করেন অবতার ।
আপনে আচরি' ভক্তি করেন প্রচার ॥ ৯৮ ॥

āpani śrī-kṛṣṇa yadi karena avatāra
Himself Śrī Kṛṣṇa if makes descent
āpane ācari' bhakti karena pracāra
Himself practising devotion makes preaching

98 "If Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself descends, He will practise devotion Himself and preach it.

নাম বিনু কলিকালে ধর্ম্ম নাহি আর ।
কলিকালে কৈছে হবে কৃষ্ণ অবতার ॥ ৯৯ ॥

nāma vinu kali-kāle dharma nāhi āra
the Name except in the age of Kali religion none other
kali-kāle kaiche habe kṛṣṇa avatāra
in the age of Kali how will be Kṛṣṇa's descent

99 In the age of Kali there is no religion but the Holy Name. Yet how will Kṛṣṇa descend in the age of Kali?

Kṛṣṇa descends only by the power of pure service —

শুদ্ধভাবে করিব কৃষ্ণের আরাধন ।
নিরন্তর সদৈন্যে করিব নিবেদন ॥ ১০০ ॥

śuddha-bhāve kariba kṛṣṇera ārādhana
with a pure heart I shall do Kṛṣṇa's worship
nirantara sadainye kariba nivedana
constantly with humility I shall make entreaty

100 I shall worship Kṛṣṇa with a pure heart and entreat Him constantly with humility.

Only Viṣṇu can bring Viṣṇu down — hence his name, Advaita —

আনিয়া কৃষ্ণেরে করোঁ কীর্ত্তন সঞ্চার ।
তবে সে 'অদ্বৈত' নাম সফল আমার ॥ ১০১ ॥

āniyā kṛṣṇere karoṅ kīrtana sañcāra
bringing Kṛṣṇa I make of kīrtana the spreading
tabe se 'advaita' nāma saphala āmāra
then indeed Advaita name fruitful My

101 If I bring Kṛṣṇa and spread *kīrtana*, only then will My name Advaita be fulfilled."

কৃষ্ণ বশ করিবেন কোন্ আরাধনে ।
বিচারিতে এক শ্লোক আইল তাঁর মনে ॥ ১০২ ॥

kṛṣṇa vaśa karibena kon ārādhane
Kṛṣṇa subdued to make by what worship
vicārite eka śloka āila tāṅra mane
while considering one verse came to His mind

102 As He considered by what worship He could win Kṛṣṇa over, a verse came to His mind:

*The devotee's self-surrender defeats the Unconquerable (words of the *Viṣṇu-dharma* and the *Gautamīya-tantra*) —*

তুলসীদলমাত্রেণ জলস্য চুলুকেন বা ।
বিক্রীণীতে স্বমাত্মানং ভক্তেভ্যো ভক্তবৎসলঃ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

tulasī-dala-mātreṇa
of tulasī a leaf merely by
jalasya culukena vā
of water by a palmful or
vikrīṇīte svam ātmānaṁ
sells His own self
bhaktebhyo bhakta-vatsalaḥ
to the devotees affectionate to His devotees

103 "Kṛṣṇa, who is affectionate to His devotees, sells Himself to them for merely a leaf of tulasī or a palmful of water." (Gautamīya-tantra)

Anubhāṣya.

bhakta-vatsalaḥ (Bhagavān, devoted to His own) **tulasī-dala-mātreṇa** (with merely a *tulasī* leaf, without sandal paste, *mantras* and the like) **jalasya culukena** (with a mouthful of water) **vā bhaktebhyaḥ ātmānaṁ vikrīṇīte** (places Himself in their power).

এ শ্লোকার্থ আচার্য্য করেন বিচারণ ।
কৃষ্ণকে তুলসীজল দেয় যেই জন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

তার ঋণ শোধিতে কৃষ্ণ করেন চিন্তন ।
'জল-তুলসীর সম কিছু ঘরে নাহি ধন' ॥ ১০৫ ॥

e ślokārtha ācārya karena vicāraṇa
this the meaning of the verse the Ācārya makes consideration
kṛṣṇake tulasī-jala deya yei jana
to Kṛṣṇa tulasī and water gives who the person
tāra ṛṇa śodhite kṛṣṇa karena cintana
his debt to repay Kṛṣṇa makes thought
'jala-tulasīra sama kichu ghare nāhi dhana'
to water and tulasī equal any in the house not wealth

104–105 The Ācārya pondered the meaning of this verse: "When someone offers Kṛṣṇa tulasī and water, Kṛṣṇa thinks how to repay His debt to that person: 'In My house there is no wealth equal to water and tulasī.'

তবে আত্মা বেচি' করে ঋণের শোধন ।
এত ভাবি' আচার্য্য করেন আরাধন ॥ ১০৬ ॥

tabe ātmā veci' kare ṛṇera śodhana
then Himself selling makes of the debt repayment
eta bhāvi' ācārya karena ārādhana
thus thinking the Ācārya makes worship

106 So He repays the debt by selling Himself." Thinking in this way, the Ācārya began His worship.

গঙ্গাজলে তুলসীমঞ্জরী অনুক্ষণ ।
কৃষ্ণপাদপদ্ম ভাবি' করে সমর্পণ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

gaṅgā-jale tulasī-mañjarī anukṣaṇa
with Gaṅgā water tulasī buds constantly
kṛṣṇa-pāda-padma bhāvi' kare samarpaṇa
Kṛṣṇa's feet lotus meditating on makes offering

107 Meditating on Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, He constantly offered them tulasī buds (*mañjarī*) with Gaṅgā water.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When a *tulasī* leaf and merely a mouthful of water are offered to Śrī Kṛṣṇa with devotion, He sells Himself to the devotee out of love for His devotees.

Some manuscripts contain two more verses: “A *tulasī* leaf with a bud at its tip, double and small, is called a *mañjarī*; it is celebrated in the worship of Kṛṣṇa. As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so the *mañjarī* is dear to Hari; therefore one should offer it with care, mixed with sandal.”

Kṛṣṇa cannot repay His debt to one who offers Him water and *tulasī*, and so He repays it by giving His very self in exchange. Therefore, to make Kṛṣṇa descend in His own true form, Advaita Ācārya kept offering Gaṅgā water with *tulasī-mañjarīs* at Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet.

কৃষ্ণের আহ্বান করে করিয়া হুঙ্কার ।
এমতে কৃষ্ণেরে করাইল অবতার ॥ ১০৮ ॥

kṛṣṇera āhvāna kare kariyā huṅkāra
of Kṛṣṇa the invocation makes making a roar
e-mate kṛṣṇere karāila avatāra
in this way Kṛṣṇa caused descent

108 With mighty roars He called out to Kṛṣṇa, and in this way He caused Kṛṣṇa to descend.

Kṛṣṇa Himself displays the pastimes of Gaura to fulfill His devotee's desire — the distribution of love for Kṛṣṇa —

চৈতন্যের অবতারে এই মুখ্য হেতু ।
ভক্তের ইচ্ছায় অবতরে ধর্ম্মসেতু ॥ ১০৯ ॥

caitanyera avatāre ei mukhya hetu
of Caitanya in the descent this main cause
bhaktera icchāya avatare dharma-setu
of the devotee by the desire descends the upholder of religion

109 This is the main cause of Caitanya's descent: the Lord, the upholder of religion, descends by the desire of His devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, the bridge of *dharma*, descends by the desire of His devotee. Caitanya appeared at the prayer of the great devotee Advaita Ācārya.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 3, Chapter 9, verse 11)*

ত্বং ভক্তিযোগপরিভাবিত-হৃৎসরোজ
আস্‌সে শ্রুতেক্ষিতপথো ননু নাথ পুংসাম্ ৷
যদ্যদ্ধিয়া ত উরুগায় বিভাবয়ন্তি
তত্তদ্বপুঃ প্রণয়সে সদনুগ্রহায় ॥ ১১০ ॥

tvaṁ bhakti-yoga-paribhāvita-hṛt-saroja
You by bhakti-yoga purified of the heart in the lotus
āsse śrutekṣita-patho nanu nātha puṁsām
reside whose path is seen by hearing indeed O Lord of persons
yad yad dhiyā ta urugāya vibhāvayanti
whatever whatever with the mind Your O widely sung Lord they contemplate
tat tad vapuḥ praṇayase sad-anugrahāya
that that form You manifest to favor the devoted

110 "O Lord, You are seen by the path of hearing, and You dwell in the lotus of the heart purified by *bhakti-yoga*. O widely glorified Lord, whatever form of Yours Your devotees contemplate, You manifest that very form to show them Your favor." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.9.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Brahmā said: "O Lord, You always move along the paths of Your devotees' hearing and sight. You always dwell in the lotus of their hearts, purified by *bhakti-yoga*. O Urugāya, whatever eternal form of Yours the devotees contemplate in their hearts, out of mercy to them You manifest that very form."

Thus ends the third chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

[0]: Unclear passage: the edition (scan checked) reads *sarva-loka-draṣṭāraṁ kṛṣṇaṁ gauram api* (literally, "Kṛṣṇa, the seer of all people, though golden"). Translated by the sense, following the parallel with the next phrase, *bhakta-viśeṣa-dṛṣṭau* ("in the eyes of special devotees"): one would expect *sarva-loka-dṛṣṭau gauram api*, "though golden in the eyes of all people." [0]: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.19.24. [0]: *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 6.255.

Anubhāṣya.

Having attained the *darśana* and mercy of Bhagavān through austerity, Brahmā, wishing to create, offers Him prayers:

nanu (O) **nātha** (O Lord) **śrutekṣita-pathaḥ** (He whose path is seen through *śruta*, hearing the conclusions of scripture) **tvaṁ puṁsāṁ bhakti-yoga-paribhāvita-hṛt-saroja** (in the lotus of the heart, purified, made fit, by *bhakti-yoga*, that is, by *prema*) **āsse** (You dwell). **dhiyā yad yad vibhāvayanti** (contemplate), **[he] urugāya** (O You who are sung of in many ways — Urukrama), **sad-anugrahāya** (to show mercy to the *sat*, the devotees) **tat tad vapuḥ** (body) **praṇayase** (You bring fully near to them, You manifest).

Thus ends the third chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

[0]: That is, 4,320,000. [0]: So in the edition (৯৭৫৩২০০০০). [0]: The edition gives "Bhāg. 9.7.67" — apparently a misprint: the same refusal of the four kinds of liberation by devotees content with service is found in the Lord's words to Durvāsā about His devotees, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.4.67. [0]: *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.3. [0]: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.32 (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.51). [0]: In the edition this section is also numbered 83; by its content it belongs to verse 84.

এই শ্লোকের অর্থ কহি সংক্ষেপের সার ।
ভক্তের ইচ্ছায় কৃষ্ণের সর্ব্ব অবতার ॥ ১১১ ॥

ei ślokera artha kahi saṅkṣepera sāra
of this verse the meaning I tell in brief the essence
bhaktera icchāya kṛṣṇera sarva avatāra
of the devotee by the desire of Kṛṣṇa all descents

111 I tell the essence of this verse in brief: all of Kṛṣṇa's descents take place by the desire of His devotees.

চতুর্থ শ্লোকের অর্থ হৈল সুনিশ্চিতে ।
অবতীর্ণ হৈলা গৌর প্রেম প্রকাশিতে ॥ ১১২ ॥

caturtha ślokera artha haila suniścite
of the fourth verse the meaning became well established
avatīrṇa hailā gaura prema prakāśite
descended became Gaura love to reveal

112 Thus the meaning of the fourth verse has been firmly established: Gaura descended to reveal love (*prema*).

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১১৩ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
Caitanya-caritāmṛta tells Kṛṣṇadāsa

113 Ever hoping for the mercy of the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.